

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Scheduled and Tribal Areas - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Scheduled and Tribal Areas	
1. ARTICLES: TRIBAL AREA ADMINISTRATION ACTS	2. TRIBAL RESOLUTIONS
3. ARTICLES: SCHEDULE MAP	4. TERRITORIES THAT BECOME SCHEDULE AREAS
5. CURRENT ARTS SCHEDULE DATE MAP	6. ARE A SCHEDULED AREA & DECLARED IN PAPER
7. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS AND DEFINITIONS	8. ARTS SCHEDULES: DECLARATION
9. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	10. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
11. THE ARTS AND THE CLAUSE	12. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
13. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	14. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
15. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	16. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
17. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	18. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
19. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	20. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
21. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	22. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
23. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	24. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
25. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	26. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
27. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	28. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
29. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	30. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
31. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	32. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
33. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	34. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
35. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	36. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
37. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	38. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
39. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	40. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
41. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	42. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
43. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	44. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
45. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	46. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
47. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	48. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
49. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	50. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
51. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	52. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
53. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	54. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
55. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	56. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
57. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	58. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
59. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	60. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
61. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	62. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
63. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	64. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
65. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	66. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
67. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	68. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
69. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	70. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
71. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	72. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
73. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	74. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
75. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	76. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
77. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	78. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
79. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	80. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
81. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	82. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
83. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	84. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
85. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	86. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
87. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	88. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
89. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	90. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
91. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	92. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
93. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	94. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
95. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	96. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
97. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	98. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS
99. ARTS SCHEDULES: DEPARTMENT OF THE GOVERNMENT'S REPORT	100. ARTS SCHEDULES: CONCEPTS

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Polity 26 - Scheduled and Tribal Areas - Complete Topic Package	7
DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT	9
EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL	9
BASIC LEARNING SESSION	10
SESSION 1 - WHY SPECIAL TRIBAL-AREA ADMINISTRATION EXISTS	10
SESSION 2 - HISTORICAL EVOLUTION	11
SESSION 3 - ARTICLE 244 MASTER MAP	13
SESSION 4 - TERMINOLOGY THAT DECIDES CLOSE OPTIONS	14
SESSION 5 - CURRENT FIFTH SCHEDULE STATE MAP	15
SESSION 6 - HOW A SCHEDULED AREA IS DECLARED OR CHANGED	16
SESSION 7 - ADMINISTRATIVE CRITERIA VERSUS CONSTITUTIONAL POWER	17
SESSION 8 - FIFTH SCHEDULE EXECUTIVE CHAIN	19
SESSION 9 - ACCOUNTABILITY MEANING OF THE GOVERNOR'S REPORT	20
SESSION 10 - TRIBES ADVISORY COUNCIL: COMPOSITION	21
SESSION 11 - TAC DUTY AND ITS CEILING	22
SESSION 12 - GOVERNOR'S LAW-APPLICATION POWER	23
SESSION 13 - GOVERNOR'S REGULATION POWER	24
SESSION 14 - GOVERNOR DISCRETION: SAFE ANSWER RULE	26
SESSION 15 - ARTICLE 339: COMMISSION AND UNION DIRECTIONS	27
SESSION 16 - ARTICLE 275(1): FISCAL SUPPORT	28
SESSION 17 - FIFTH SCHEDULE INSTITUTIONAL DASHBOARD	29
SESSION 18 - SIXTH SCHEDULE TERRITORIAL MAP	30
SESSION 19 - AUTONOMOUS DISTRICT AND AUTONOMOUS REGION	31
SESSION 20 - GOVERNOR'S TERRITORIAL ORGANISATION POWER	33
SESSION 21 - COUNCIL COMPOSITION: ORDINARY MODEL AND EXCEPTIONS	34
SESSION 22 - CURRENT INSTITUTIONAL EXAMPLES	35
SESSION 23 - SPECIAL ASSAM ARRANGEMENTS	36
SESSION 24 - SIXTH SCHEDULE LEGISLATIVE POWERS	37
SESSION 25 - RESERVED FOREST AND MINERAL TRAPS	39

SESSION 26 - SIXTH SCHEDULE EXECUTIVE FUNCTIONS	40
SESSION 27 - SIXTH SCHEDULE JUDICIAL POWERS	41
SESSION 28 - SIXTH SCHEDULE FISCAL POWERS	42
SESSION 29 - MINERAL ROYALTY ARRANGEMENT	43
SESSION 30 - APPLICATION OF PARLIAMENT AND STATE LAWS	45
SESSION 31 - GOVERNOR'S CHECKS ON COUNCILS	46
SESSION 32 - PRESIDENT'S ROLE IN THE SIXTH SCHEDULE	47
SESSION 33 - FIFTH VERSUS SIXTH SCHEDULE: EXACT COMPARISON	48
SESSION 34 - FOUR SYSTEMS THAT MUST NOT BE COLLAPSED	50
SESSION 35 - WHY PESA WAS ENACTED	51
SESSION 36 - PESA VILLAGE AND GRAM SABHA	52
SESSION 37 - PESA POWER VERBS	53
SESSION 38 - CONSULTATION, RECOMMENDATION AND APPROVAL ARE DIFFERENT	55
SESSION 39 - PESA LAND AND MINOR-MINERAL DECISION FLOW	56
SESSION 40 - PESA REPRESENTATION AND RESERVATIONS	57
SESSION 41 - FRA RELATIONSHIP	58
SESSION 42 - PESA AND FRA: OVERLAP WITHOUT MERGER	59
SESSION 43 - LAND ALIENATION: PREVENTION AND RESTORATION	61
SESSION 44 - SAMATHA (1997): HOLDING AND BOUNDARY	62
SESSION 45 - ORISSA MINING CORPORATION (2013) / NIYAMGIRI	63
SESSION 46 - DEVELOPMENT, MINING AND DISPLACEMENT CONFLICT	64
SESSION 47 - FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS AND DPSP INTERFACE	66
SESSION 48 - ACCOUNTABILITY ARCHITECTURE	67
SESSION 49 - CURRENT IMPLEMENTATION CONTROL: PESA RULES	68
SESSION 50 - CAPACITY, CONVERGENCE AND INSTITUTIONAL REFORM	69
SESSION 51 - LADAKH AND EXTENSION DEBATES	71
SESSION 52 - REFORM PRINCIPLES	72
SESSION 53 - PRELIMS TRAP BOARD	73
SESSION 54 - MAINS ANSWER-WRITING METHOD	74
SESSION 55 - THESIS SELECTOR	75
POLITY HOSTILE SEMANTIC-REVIEW CORE CONTROL	76
Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control	77

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 77

Original MCQ loop - strict continuous A -> B -> C -> D rotation	77
OM1. Article 244 mapping	78
OM2. Fifth Schedule States	78
OM3. Declaration authority	78
OM4. Executive power	78
OM5. TAC composition	78
OM6. TAC function	78
OM7. Fifth Schedule regulations	79
OM8. Law-application direction	79
OM9. Article 339	79
OM10. Article 275(1)	79
OM11. Fifth Schedule evaluation	79
OM12. Territorial trap	79
OM13. Sixth Schedule States	80
OM14. Autonomous regions	80
OM15. Ordinary council composition	80
OM16. Council law	80
OM17. Council legislative field	80
OM18. Forest competence	80
OM19. Council courts	81
OM20. Fiscal autonomy	81
OM21. Mineral royalties	81
OM22. Bodoland exception	81
OM23. Assam asymmetry	81
OM24. Article 244A	81
OM25. PESA reach	82
OM26. Acquisition and R&R	82
OM27. Minor minerals	82
OM28. Section 4(m)	82
OM29. FRA claims	82
OM30. CFR right	82

OM31. Niyamgiri holding	83
OM32. Samatha (1997) limit	83
OM33. Article 371 distinction	83
OM34. Ordinary Panchayats	83
OM35. Current PESA rule status	83
OM36. Reform principle	83
Remedial MCQs - strict continuation A -> C -> A -> D rotation	84
RM1. President-Governor reversal	84
RM2. Assent reversal	84
RM3. TAC versus ADC	84
RM4. State executive power	84
RM5. PESA scope	84
RM6. PESA verb	84
RM7. Forest rights	85
RM8. Niyamgiri limit	85
RM9. Council forest power	85
RM10. Article 244A	85
RM11. Current law control	85
RM12. Answer-writing sequence	85
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	86
Verified routed Prelims PYQs	86
PYQ 1 - UPSC Prelims 2019, Q50	86
PYQ 2 - UPSC Prelims 2022, Q73	86
PYQ 3 - UPSC Prelims 2023, Q39	86
PYQ 4 - UPSC Prelims 2024, Q84	87
PYQ 5 - UPSC Prelims 2025, Q56	87
PYQ 6 - UPSC Prelims 2026, Q57	87
PYQ coverage control	88
Original solved Mains practice	88
M1. Explain the constitutional rationale for separate administration of Scheduled and tribal areas. (10 marks, 150 words)	88
M2. "The Fifth Schedule is constitutionally powerful but institutionally under-activated." Examine. (10 marks, 150 words)	89
M3. Discuss the legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers of Sixth Schedule councils and their constitutional limits. (15 marks, 250 words)	91

M4. Compare the Fifth and Sixth Schedules as competing models of tribal governance. (15 marks, 250 words)	92
M5. PESA is a calibrated code of community power, not a universal Gram Sabha veto. Discuss. (15 marks, 250 words)	94
M6. Analyse how the Fifth Schedule, PESA, FRA and judicial decisions regulate land and mining conflicts in tribal areas. (15 marks, 250 words)	95
M7. Design an accountability reform for Fifth and Sixth Schedule institutions. (20 marks, 250 words)	97
M8. Should Sixth Schedule-style autonomy be extended to Ladakh or other tribal regions? Critically examine. (20 marks, 250 words)	98
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	100
Scheduled & Tribal Areas (Article 244, Fifth & Sixth Schedules, Part X) - ADVANCED / COMPLETE	100
THE BIG PICTURE □	100
PART A - FIFTH SCHEDULE (Administration of Scheduled Areas) □	100
PART B - SIXTH SCHEDULE (Administration of Tribal Areas) □	100
PART C - FIFTH vs SIXTH SCHEDULE (compare) □□	101
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	102
Article 244 and territorial vocabulary	102
Constitutional rationale and history	102
Fifth Schedule State and declaration control	102
Fifth Schedule institutional chain	103
Article 275 and Article 339	103
Sixth Schedule architecture	103
Sixth Schedule powers and limits	103
Fifth-Sixth exact comparison	104
PESA power code	104
FRA linkage	104
Land, mining and case law	105
Article 371 and ordinary Panchayat distinction	105
Accountability and reform recall	105
Last-minute PYQ routes and traps	105
Rapid Mains spines	106
Final twenty-second recall	106
COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM	107

Polity 26 - Scheduled and Tribal Areas - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** 26 | **GS-II + Prelims** | **Export date:** 2026-08-28 **Approval:** false - awaiting explicit user approval. **Evidence key:** [FACT] verified constitutional, statutory, judicial or official proposition; [ANALYSIS] reasoned exam synthesis; [CURRENT] dated legal or institutional control; [LIMIT] qualification preventing overstatement.

Package method, source priority and current legal control

- [FACT] Source order followed: basic/Scheduled-and-Tribal-Areas.md -> advanced/26_Scheduled-and-Tribal-Areas.md -> Polity 23 Panchayati Raj, Polity 22 Special Provisions, Fundamental Rights, Supreme Court, Environment/FRA and EIA owners only for cross-links -> audited PYQ routing ledgers and locally held official Prelims papers/keys -> authoritative Constitution, India Code, Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Ministry of Panchayati Raj, Supreme Court and official State/ADC sources. Qdrant was not used.
- [CURRENT] Legal and institutional control date is **5 September 2026, Asia/Kolkata**.
- [CURRENT] **Live official refresh, 5 September 2026:** Ministry of Tribal Affairs Fifth-Schedule material, Ministry of Panchayati Raj PESA-rules listings, MHA Ladakh committee material and the official Supreme Court judgment source were rechecked. Jharkhand PESA Rules, 2025 remain listed; no Sixth-Schedule grant to Ladakh was located.
- [FACT] Article **244(1)** applies the Fifth Schedule to Scheduled Areas and Scheduled Tribes in States other than Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. Article **244(2)** applies the Sixth Schedule to tribal areas in those four States.
- [CURRENT] The official Ministry of Panchayati Raj state-wise document identifies notified Fifth Schedule areas in **10 States:** Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha and Rajasthan.
- [LIMIT] A State's inclusion in that list does not make the whole State a Scheduled Area. Only territory covered by the operative Presidential Orders has that status. Presence of a Scheduled Tribe population also does not by itself notify a Scheduled Area.
- [CURRENT] The Ministry of Panchayati Raj's official PESA-rules listing contains rules for nine of the ten PESA States, including **Jharkhand Rules, 2025**; it does not list a separate notified Odisha PESA Rules instrument. This is a dated implementation control, not a claim that statutory compliance is complete in the nine.
- [CURRENT] Ladakh remains a Union Territory outside the Sixth Schedule. Official MHA material records continuing consultation through the High-Powered Committee process; no official notification granting Sixth Schedule status was located by the control date.
- [LIMIT] The Fifth Schedule assigns important functions to the Governor but does not textually convert every such function into unreviewable personal discretion. Do not state that the Governor may always disregard ministerial advice.
- [LIMIT] A Tribal Advisory Council is advisory. A Sixth Schedule council is autonomous but not sovereign, not a State legislature and not outside the State's executive authority.
- [LIMIT] PESA uses different legal verbs - **approve, identify, certify, consult, recommend, own, regulate, control and restore**. It does not create one undifferentiated Gram Sabha veto over every project.
- [LIMIT] Current dashboards, claim counts, title acreage, council officeholders and programme totals change. This package uses durable legal design and dated official controls rather than freezing unstable totals.

Authoritative control set

1. Constitution of India, Legislative Department, Articles 244, 244A, 275(1), 339 and the Fifth and Sixth Schedules.
2. Ministry of Tribal Affairs, official *Scheduled Areas* note and Presidential-Order inventory.
3. Ministry of Panchayati Raj, official state-wise notified Fifth Schedule areas, PESA Act and State PESA rules listings.
4. Provisions of the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996, section 4, India Code.

5. Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006, especially sections 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6, India Code.
6. *Samatha (1997) v. State of Andhra Pradesh*, (1997) 8 SCC 191, read with the Andhra Pradesh Scheduled Areas Land Transfer Regulation and later scope qualification.
7. *Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) Ltd. v. Ministry of Environment and Forest*, Supreme Court, 18 April 2013.
8. Official Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram government/ADC material for current institutional examples.
9. Official UPSC papers locally held for 2019, 2023, 2024, 2025 and 2026 and official Set-A keys locally held for 2024-2025.

Roadmap

Stage	Coverage	Exam outcome
Rationale and history	exclusion, protection and self-government	explains why two Schedules exist
Article 244 map	Fifth, Sixth, 244A, 275 and 339	solves provision traps
Fifth Schedule	declaration, executive chain, TAC and Governor powers	handles protective administration
Sixth Schedule	districts, regions, councils and powers	handles autonomous government
Exact comparison	Fifth, Sixth, Article 371 and ordinary Panchayats	prevents false equivalence
PESA	section 4 power verbs and limits	answers Gram Sabha questions precisely
FRA	claims, CFR and conservation duties	connects tenure with self-governance
Land and mining	PESA, FRA, State land law and cases	builds rights-development analysis
Accountability	Governor, State, Union, councils and Gram Sabha	identifies institutional gaps
Current reform	rules, capacity, convergence and review	adds dated evidence safely
Workbook	six routed Prelims demands, 48 rotated MCQs and eight solved Mains	converts doctrine into marks

Scope ownership and cross-links

- **Polity 22 - Special Provisions:** owns Article 371 family, Article 370 and the larger asymmetric-federalism framework. This package distinguishes those provisions from Fifth/Sixth Schedule protection.
- **Polity 23 - Panchayati Raj:** owns Part IX, ordinary Gram Sabha and PRI architecture. This package owns Article 243M exclusion and PESA's Scheduled-Area modifications.
- **Polity 07 - Fundamental Rights / DPSP:** owns Articles 14, 19, 21, 25-26, 29, 38, 39(b), 46 and Article 300A doctrine. This package applies them to tribal land, culture, religion and dignified participation.
- **Polity 18/21 - Judiciary:** owns judicial review and court structure. This package owns the tribal-governance holdings and limits of *Samatha (1997)* and *Orissa Mining Corporation (2013)*.
- **Environment 11 - Forest Rights Act:** owns full forest-law doctrine, eligibility and claims detail. This package owns the governance interface between FRA, PESA and the Schedules.
- **Environment 16 / Economy land-mineral owners:** own EIA, forest clearance, mineral law and land acquisition in depth. This package owns the constitutional/community decision chain.
- **Governance:** owns participatory governance, social audit and delivery systems. This package uses them only to design accountability in Scheduled Areas.
- [LIMIT] Cross-links prevent duplicate ownership but do not make this package dependent on another file for answering a Fifth/Sixth Schedule, PESA or tribal-autonomy question.

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Polity Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Text hierarchy	Constitution/Act/rule/notification -> binding judgment -> authoritative institution -> Constituent Assembly material -> standard textbook.
Legal precision	State exact Article, Part, Schedule, amendment, case, date, institution, procedure, exception and current operative status.
Doctrine method	Text -> institutional mechanism -> controlling case -> exception/limit -> present legal status.
Chronology	Enactment, commencement, amendment, judgment and implementation dates remain separate.
Boundary method	Topic ownership and cross-owner bridges are explicit; adjacent PYQs never become fabricated direct routes.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, examiner-grade model, timed compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Polity\basic\Scheduled-and-Tribal-Areas.md **Canonical topic owner:**

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Polity\basic\Scheduled-and-Tribal-Areas.md **Optional Advanced owner:**

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Polity\advanced\26_Scheduled-and-Tribal-Areas.md **Official syllabus**

mapping: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Polity\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Four independent ledgers:** literal syllabus/index, indispensable

prerequisites, standard textbook taxonomy and complete routed 2018-2026 PYQ demands were built before repair.

- **Hostile search:** missing Articles, Parts, Schedules, amendments, cases,

institutional mechanisms, exceptions, chronology, source status and cross-owner boundaries are hard failures.

- **Answer rule:** claim -> exact constitutional/statutory/case evidence ->

institutional analysis -> exception or qualification.

- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-05:** Rechecked 2026-09-05: official constitutional, MoTA, MoPR/India Code, MHA and Supreme Court sources preserve distinct Fifth Schedule, Sixth Schedule, PESA and FRA layers. MHA's 4 August 2026 answer lists ten Sixth-Schedule ADCs; Ladakh has not been added to the Schedule.

Authoritative live sources:

- <https://legislative.gov.in/en/constitution-of-india>
- <https://tribal.nic.in/DivisionsFiles/clm/ScheduledAreas.pdf>
- https://www.indiacode.nic.in/show-data?actid=AC_CEN_18_21_00007_199640_1517807323053§ionId=42808§ionno=4&orderno=4
- <https://tribal.nic.in/FRA/data/FRARulesBook.pdf>
- <https://www.mha.gov.in/MHA1/Par2017/pdfs/par2026-pdfs/LS04082026/2745.pdf>
- <https://api.sci.gov.in/judis/4271.pdf>
- <https://api.sci.gov.in/judis/19058.pdf>

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - WHY SPECIAL TRIBAL-AREA ADMINISTRATION EXISTS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Why Special Tribal-Area Administration Exists explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing why special tribal-area administration exists.

Technical definition: Why Special Tribal-Area Administration Exists operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing why special tribal-area administration exists, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

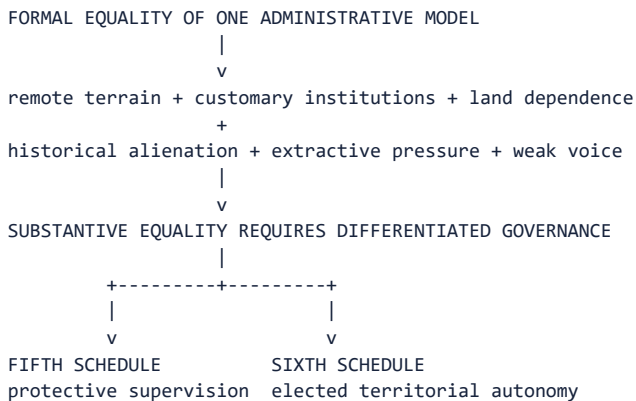
Why Special Tribal-Area Administration Exists is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing why special tribal-area administration exists.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- special
- tribal
- area
- administration
- exists

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with special to explain the mechanism, and use tribal for the decisive comparison or qualification.

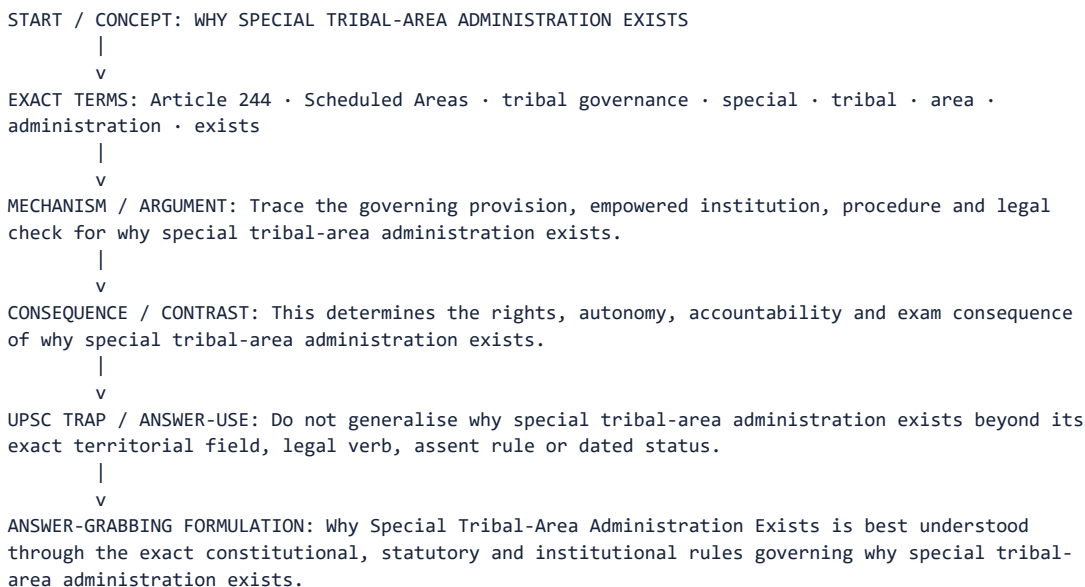
Visual 1 - The constitutional problem



Caption: The Schedules are devices of substantive equality: they differentiate administration to protect land, culture, voice and self-government.

- [FACT] Part X recognises that ordinary State administration may require constitutional modification in specified tribal regions.
- [ANALYSIS] The central design question is not "special privilege versus equality" but whether identical rules would reproduce unequal bargaining power and historical dispossession.
- [LIMIT] Protection can become paternalism if communities remain subjects of administration rather than participants in decisions.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - WHY SPECIAL TRIBAL-AREA ADMINISTRATION EXISTS



SESSION 2 - HISTORICAL EVOLUTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Historical Evolution explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing historical evolution.

Technical definition: Historical Evolution operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing historical evolution, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Historical Evolution is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing historical evolution.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Article 244**
- **Scheduled Areas**
- **tribal governance**
- **historical**
- **evolution**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with historical to explain the mechanism, and use evolution for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 2 - From exclusion to negotiated constitutionalism

1874 Scheduled Districts Act
|
colonial excluded / partially excluded areas
|
Government of India Act, 1935
|
Constituent Assembly tribal-area subcommittees
- A.V. Thakkar: areas outside Assam
- Gopinath Bordoloi: Assam tribal/excluded areas
|
1950 Constitution
Fifth Schedule: protective administration
Sixth Schedule: autonomous district/regional councils
|
1996 PESA: self-government layer in Fifth Schedule areas
|
2006 FRA: tenure and community forest-resource rights

- [FACT] Colonial "excluded" arrangements largely insulated administration from representative provincial institutions while concentrating power in executive authorities.
- [FACT] The Constitution retained differentiation but added representative, welfare and rights-oriented purposes.
- [ANALYSIS] The Fifth Schedule partially transforms the colonial guardian model; the Sixth Schedule moves further toward territorial self-government.
- [LIMIT] Constitutional continuity in special administration does not mean identical purposes: democratic accountability and tribal agency are now controlling values.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - HISTORICAL EVOLUTION

START / CONCEPT: HISTORICAL EVOLUTION
|
v
EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · historical · evolution
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for historical evolution.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of historical evolution.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise historical evolution beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Historical Evolution is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing historical evolution.

SESSION 3 - ARTICLE 244 MASTER MAP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Article 244 Master Map explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 244 master map.

Technical definition: Article 244 Master Map operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 244 master map, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Article 244 Master Map is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 244 master map.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Article 244**
- **Scheduled Areas**
- **tribal governance**
- **article**
- **master**
- **map**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with article to explain the mechanism, and use master for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 3 - The constitutional spine

Provision	Territorial reach	Core function
Article 244(1)	Scheduled Areas and ST administration outside the four Sixth Schedule States	applies Fifth Schedule
Article 244(2)	tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram	applies Sixth Schedule
Article 244A	Assam only	permits Parliament to create an autonomous State with legislature/CoM
Article 275(1)	States requiring specified tribal-welfare/Scheduled-Area support	grants-in-aid
Article 339(1)	Scheduled Areas and ST welfare	presidential commission
Article 339(2)	States	Union directions on essential ST-welfare schemes

- [FACT] Article 244 is the gateway; the detailed institutions are in the Schedules.
- [ANALYSIS] Articles 275 and 339 add fiscal and supervisory support to the territorial design.
- [LIMIT] Article 244A is an enabling power for an autonomous State within Assam, not an automatic consequence of a Sixth Schedule council.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ARTICLE 244 MASTER MAP

START / CONCEPT: ARTICLE 244 MASTER MAP

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · article · master · map

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for article 244 master map.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of article 244 master map.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise article 244 master map beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Article 244 Master Map is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 244 master map.

SESSION 4 - TERMINOLOGY THAT DECIDES CLOSE OPTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Terminology That Decides Close Options explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing terminology that decides close options.

Technical definition: Terminology That Decides Close Options operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing terminology that decides close options, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Terminology That Decides Close Options is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing terminology that decides close options.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- terminology
- decides
- close
- options

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with terminology to explain the mechanism, and use decides for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 4 - Scheduled Area, tribal area and Scheduled Tribe

Term	Legal source	Who specifies/organises?	Exam trap
Scheduled Area	Fifth Schedule, paragraph 6	President by order; specified alterations involve Governor consultation	not the same as any area with ST population
tribal area	Sixth Schedule Parts I-IV	constitutional list, with gubernatorial organisation/reorganisation powers	not a Fifth Schedule label
Scheduled Tribe	Article 342	President specifies for a State/UT; Parliament alters by law	Governor does not declare the ST list
PESA village	PESA section 4(b)	habitation/hamlet-based statutory conception	need not mirror an ordinary revenue village

Memory rule: President schedules the area and tribe list through different constitutional routes; Governor organises Sixth Schedule districts/regions; PESA recognises habitation-based village life.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - TERMINOLOGY THAT DECIDES CLOSE OPTIONS

START / CONCEPT: TERMINOLOGY THAT DECIDES CLOSE OPTIONS

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · terminology · decides · close · options

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for terminology that decides close options.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of terminology that decides close options.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise terminology that decides close options beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Terminology That Decides Close Options is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing terminology that decides close options.

SESSION 5 - CURRENT FIFTH SCHEDULE STATE MAP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Current Fifth Schedule State Map explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current fifth schedule state map.

Technical definition: Current Fifth Schedule State Map operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current fifth schedule state map, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Current Fifth Schedule State Map is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current fifth schedule state map.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Fifth Schedule
- Governor
- Tribes Advisory Council
- fifth
- schedule

- map

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fifth Schedule; define Governor, connect Tribes Advisory Council with fifth to explain the mechanism, and use schedule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 5 - Officially supported 10-State inventory

WEST / CENTRAL BELT

Gujarat - Rajasthan - Maharashtra - Madhya Pradesh - Chhattisgarh

EASTERN BELT

Jharkhand - Odisha

SOUTH / DECCAN

Andhra Pradesh - Telangana

HIMALAYAN

Himachal Pradesh

- [CURRENT] The official Ministry of Panchayati Raj state-wise document lists these 10 States.
- [FACT] Their legal coverage comes from operative Presidential Orders, including post-State-reorganisation application.
- [LIMIT] District names and boundaries can change. Memorise the State inventory and declaration mechanism; verify granular district lists from current orders before quoting them.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CURRENT FIFTH SCHEDULE STATE MAP

START / CONCEPT: CURRENT FIFTH SCHEDULE STATE MAP

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Fifth Schedule • Governor • Tribes Advisory Council • fifth • schedule • map

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for current fifth schedule state map.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of current fifth schedule state map.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise current fifth schedule state map beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Current Fifth Schedule State Map is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current fifth schedule state map.

SESSION 6 - HOW A SCHEDULED AREA IS DECLARED OR CHANGED

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: How A Scheduled Area Is Declared Or Changed explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing how a scheduled area is declared or changed.

Technical definition: How A Scheduled Area Is Declared Or Changed operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing how a scheduled area is declared or changed, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

How A Scheduled Area Is Declared Or Changed is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing how a scheduled area is declared or changed.

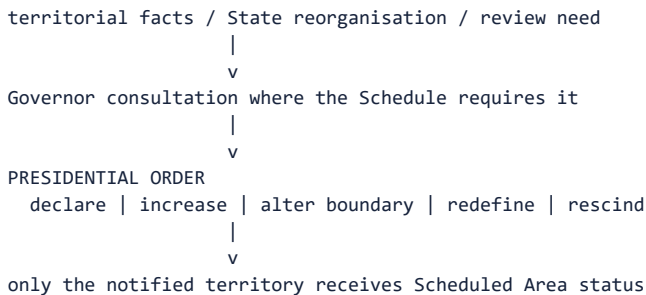
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244

- **Scheduled Areas**
- **tribal governance**
- **scheduled**
- **area**
- **declared**
- **changed**

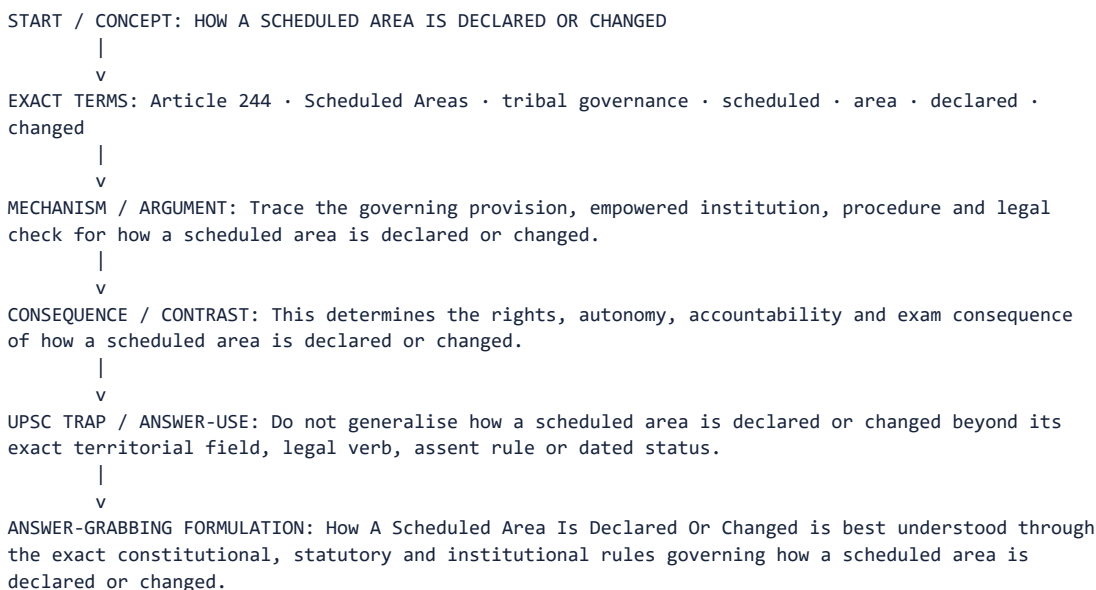
How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with scheduled to explain the mechanism, and use area for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 6 - Fifth Schedule paragraph 6 process



- [FACT] The President may declare an area a Scheduled Area.
- [FACT] The Schedule permits increase, alteration, redefinition and rescission through specified presidential orders; consultation with the Governor is required in the cases stated in paragraph 6.
- [LIMIT] Consultation is not the same as gubernatorial consent.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - HOW A SCHEDULED AREA IS DECLARED OR CHANGED



SESSION 7 - ADMINISTRATIVE CRITERIA VERSUS CONSTITUTIONAL POWER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Administrative Criteria Versus Constitutional Power explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing administrative criteria versus constitutional power.

Technical definition: Administrative Criteria Versus Constitutional Power operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing administrative criteria versus constitutional power, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Administrative Criteria Versus Constitutional Power is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing administrative criteria versus constitutional power.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- administrative
- criteria
- constitutional
- power

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with administrative to explain the mechanism, and use criteria for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 7 - Two-layer declaration test

Layer	Content	Legal weight
constitutional authority	President's order under Fifth Schedule paragraph 6	creates/changes legal status
official administrative criteria	tribal preponderance; compactness/reasonable size; viable unit; comparative economic backwardness	guides identification but does not replace notification

- [FACT] The Ministry of Tribal Affairs identifies those four administrative criteria.
- [ANALYSIS] Criteria discipline the area approach by linking protection to demographic, territorial and developmental realities.
- [LIMIT] Satisfying a criterion does not itself make an area Scheduled; notification remains indispensable.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ADMINISTRATIVE CRITERIA VERSUS CONSTITUTIONAL POWER

START / CONCEPT: ADMINISTRATIVE CRITERIA VERSUS CONSTITUTIONAL POWER

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 • Scheduled Areas • tribal governance • administrative • criteria • constitutional • power

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for administrative criteria versus constitutional power.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of administrative criteria versus constitutional power.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise administrative criteria versus constitutional power beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Administrative Criteria Versus Constitutional Power is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing administrative criteria versus constitutional power.

SESSION 8 - FIFTH SCHEDULE EXECUTIVE CHAIN

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Fifth Schedule Executive Chain explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth schedule executive chain.

Technical definition: Fifth Schedule Executive Chain operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth schedule executive chain, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

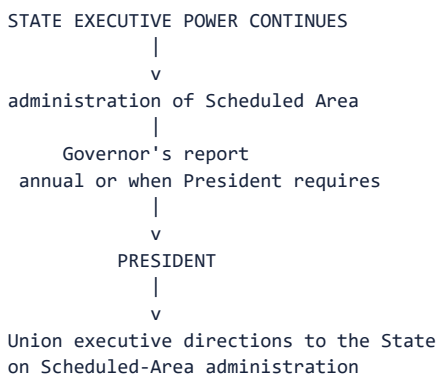
Fifth Schedule Executive Chain is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth schedule executive chain.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Fifth Schedule**
- **Governor**
- **Tribes Advisory Council**
- **fifth**
- **schedule**
- **executive**
- **chain**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fifth Schedule; define Governor, connect Tribes Advisory Council with fifth to explain the mechanism, and use schedule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 8 - State administration under Union supervision



- [FACT] The State does not lose executive power merely because an area is scheduled.
- [FACT] The Governor reports annually, or whenever required by the President, on administration of Scheduled Areas.
- [FACT] Union executive power extends to giving directions to the State regarding such administration.
- [LIMIT] The Schedule creates supervision by report and direction, not an automatic Union takeover of total administration.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FIFTH SCHEDULE EXECUTIVE CHAIN

START / CONCEPT: FIFTH SCHEDULE EXECUTIVE CHAIN

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Fifth Schedule • Governor • Tribes Advisory Council • fifth • schedule • executive • chain

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for fifth schedule executive chain.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of fifth schedule executive chain.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise fifth schedule executive chain beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Fifth Schedule Executive Chain is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth schedule executive chain.

SESSION 9 - ACCOUNTABILITY MEANING OF THE GOVERNOR'S REPORT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Accountability Meaning Of The Governor'S Report explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing accountability meaning of the governor's report.

Technical definition: Accountability Meaning Of The Governor'S Report operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing accountability meaning of the governor's report, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Accountability Meaning Of The Governor'S Report is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing accountability meaning of the governor's report.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Fifth Schedule
- Governor
- Tribes Advisory Council
- accountability
- meaning
- report

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fifth Schedule; define Governor, connect Tribes Advisory Council with accountability to explain the mechanism, and use meaning for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 9 - Report-to-remedy loop

local evidence
 land transfer | credit | services | PESA | FRA
 |
 v
 Governor's Scheduled-Area report
 |
 v
 Presidential / Union scrutiny
 |
 v
 direction, scheme correction, legislative or administrative response
 |
 v
 public and legislative follow-up

- [ANALYSIS] The report can convert local constitutional failures into an intergovernmental accountability record.
- [LIMIT] The text does not itself prescribe a public template, tabling deadline or consequence for a weak report; institutional design must supply those controls.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ACCOUNTABILITY MEANING OF THE GOVERNOR'S REPORT

START / CONCEPT: ACCOUNTABILITY MEANING OF THE GOVERNOR'S REPORT
 |
 v
 EXACT TERMS: Fifth Schedule · Governor · Tribes Advisory Council · accountability · meaning · report
 |
 v
 MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for accountability meaning of the governor's report.
 |
 v
 CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of accountability meaning of the governor's report.
 |
 v
 UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise accountability meaning of the governor's report beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.
 |
 v
 ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Accountability Meaning Of The Governor'S Report is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing accountability meaning of the governor's report.

SESSION 10 - TRIBES ADVISORY COUNCIL: COMPOSITION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Tribes Advisory Council: Composition explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing tribes advisory council: composition.

Technical definition: Tribes Advisory Council: Composition operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing tribes advisory council: composition, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Tribes Advisory Council: Composition is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing tribes advisory council: composition.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sixth Schedule
- Autonomous District Council
- Governor
- tribes
- advisory
- council

- composition

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with tribes to explain the mechanism, and use advisory for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 10 - TAC design

Feature	Fifth Schedule rule
where mandatory	each State having Scheduled Areas
possible extension	President may direct a TAC in a State having STs but no Scheduled Areas
maximum size	20 members
representation	as nearly as may be, three-fourths representatives of STs in State Legislative Assembly
shortfall	remaining seats filled by other members of those tribes

- [FACT] TAC composition seeks a legislative-representative connection rather than a purely bureaucratic advisory body.
- [LIMIT] "Three-fourths ST MLAs" is shorthand. The Schedule says representatives of STs in the Assembly and supplies a shortfall rule.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - TRIBES ADVISORY COUNCIL: COMPOSITION

START / CONCEPT: TRIBES ADVISORY COUNCIL: COMPOSITION

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Sixth Schedule · Autonomous District Council · Governor · tribes · advisory · council
· composition

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for tribes advisory council: composition.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of tribes advisory council: composition.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise tribes advisory council: composition beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Tribes Advisory Council: Composition is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing tribes advisory council: composition.

SESSION 11 - TAC DUTY AND ITS CEILING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: TAC Duty And Its Ceiling explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing tac duty and its ceiling.

Technical definition: TAC Duty And Its Ceiling operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing tac duty and its ceiling, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

TAC Duty And Its Ceiling is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing tac duty and its ceiling.

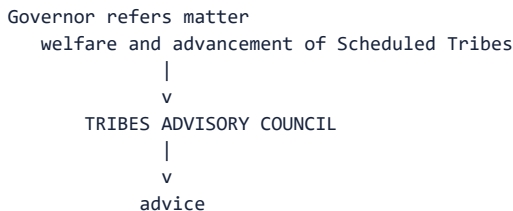
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Fifth Schedule
- Governor

- Tribes Advisory Council
- tac
- duty
- its
- ceiling

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fifth Schedule; define Governor, connect Tribes Advisory Council with tac to explain the mechanism, and use duty for the decisive comparison or qualification.

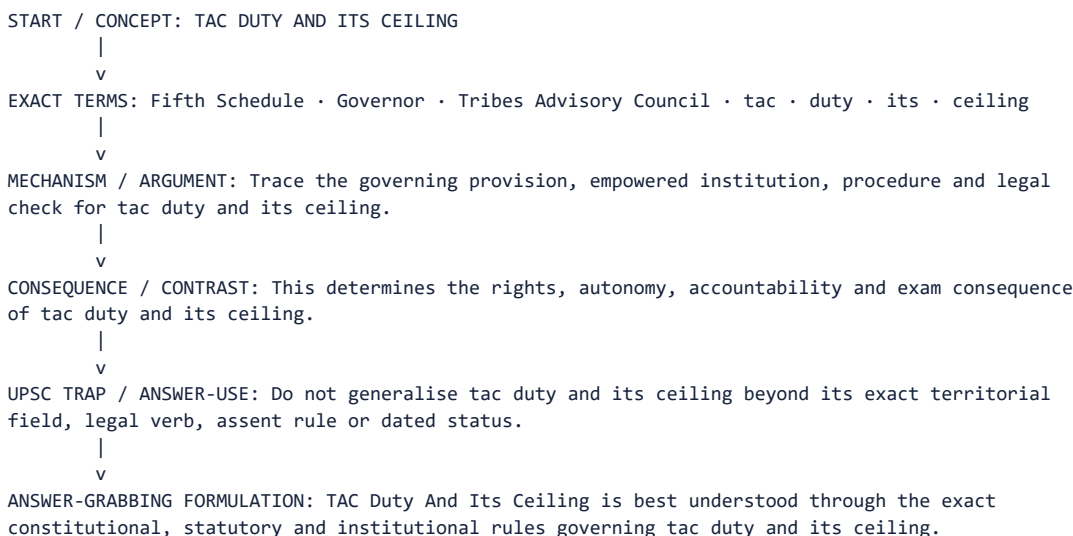
Visual 11 - Advisory, not legislative



NOT: statute | binding veto | executive order | court judgment

- [FACT] The TAC advises on matters concerning welfare and advancement of STs that the Governor refers to it.
- [ANALYSIS] Agenda control matters: an advisory body cannot scrutinise what is never referred.
- [LIMIT] Do not describe TAC advice as legally binding or TAC as the Fifth Schedule equivalent of an Autonomous District Council.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - TAC DUTY AND ITS CEILING



SESSION 12 - GOVERNOR'S LAW-APPLICATION POWER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Governor'S Law-Application Power explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's law-application power.

Technical definition: Governor'S Law-Application Power operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's law-application power, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

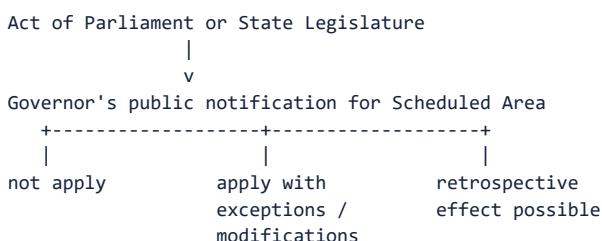
Governor'S Law-Application Power is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's law-application power.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Fifth Schedule
- Governor
- Tribes Advisory Council
- law
- application
- power

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fifth Schedule; define Governor, connect Tribes Advisory Council with law to explain the mechanism, and use application for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 12 - Paragraph 5(1) shield



- [FACT] The Governor may direct that a parliamentary or State Act shall not apply to a Scheduled Area or shall apply subject to exceptions and modifications.
- [FACT] The direction may have retrospective effect.
- [ANALYSIS] This is a constitutional adaptation power: general law can be filtered through local land, custom and institutional realities.
- [LIMIT] It is not a general power to suspend the Constitution or Fundamental Rights.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - GOVERNOR'S LAW-APPLICATION POWER

START / CONCEPT: GOVERNOR'S LAW-APPLICATION POWER

↓

EXACT TERMS: Fifth Schedule · Governor · Tribes Advisory Council · law · application · power

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for governor's law-application power.

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of governor's law-application power.

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise governor's law-application power beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Governor's Law-Application Power is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's law-application power.

SESSION 13 - GOVERNOR'S REGULATION POWER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Governor's Regulation Power explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's regulation power.

Technical definition: Governor's Regulation Power operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's regulation power, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Governor'S Regulation Power is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's regulation power.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Fifth Schedule
- Governor
- Tribes Advisory Council
- regulation
- power

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fifth Schedule; define Governor, connect Tribes Advisory Council with regulation to explain the mechanism, and use power for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 13 - Paragraph 5(2) protective subjects

Regulation field	Protective purpose
peace and good government of a Scheduled Area	tailored administration
prohibit/restrict transfer of land by or among ST members	prevent alienation
regulate allotment of land to ST members	secure access
regulate money-lending to ST members	reduce exploitative credit

Visual 14 - Regulation validity chain

draft regulation
|
consult TAC where one exists
|
Governor makes regulation
|
may amend/repeal applicable parliamentary or State law
|
submitted to President
|
NO EFFECT UNTIL PRESIDENTIAL ASSENT

- [FACT] Presidential assent is a condition of effect.
- [FACT] Consultation with the TAC is required before making such regulations where a TAC exists.
- [LIMIT] PESA later adds broader statutory self-government functions; it does not erase the constitutional regulation route.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - GOVERNOR'S REGULATION POWER

START / CONCEPT: GOVERNOR'S REGULATION POWER
|
v
EXACT TERMS: Fifth Schedule · Governor · Tribes Advisory Council · regulation · power
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for governor's regulation power.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of governor's regulation power.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise governor's regulation power beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Governor'S Regulation Power is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's regulation power.

SESSION 14 - GOVERNOR DISCRETION: SAFE ANSWER RULE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Governor Discretion: Safe Answer Rule explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor discretion: safe answer rule.

Technical definition: Governor Discretion: Safe Answer Rule operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor discretion: safe answer rule, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Governor Discretion: Safe Answer Rule is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor discretion: safe answer rule.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Fifth Schedule
- Governor
- Tribes Advisory Council
- discretion
- rule

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fifth Schedule; define Governor, connect Tribes Advisory Council with discretion to explain the mechanism, and use rule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 15 - Text, convention and review

Proposition	Safe treatment
Schedule says "Governor may"	[FACT] identifies the constitutional office holding the power
Governor acts personally in every case	[LIMIT] do not assert without a specific constitutional/judicial basis
advice can never matter	[LIMIT] overstatement
action/inaction is beyond review	[LIMIT] constitutional power remains bounded by purpose, law and judicial review

- [ANALYSIS] The exam-worthy criticism is not that the Governor owns sovereign tribal policy; it is that a protective constitutional power may remain under-used within an executive system dominated by ordinary State priorities.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - GOVERNOR DISCRETION: SAFE ANSWER RULE

START / CONCEPT: GOVERNOR DISCRETION: SAFE ANSWER RULE

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Fifth Schedule • Governor • Tribes Advisory Council • discretion • rule

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for governor discretion: safe answer rule.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of governor discretion: safe answer rule.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise governor discretion: safe answer rule beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Governor Discretion: Safe Answer Rule is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor discretion: safe answer rule.

SESSION 15 - ARTICLE 339: COMMISSION AND UNION DIRECTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Article 339: Commission And Union Directions explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 339: commission and union directions.

Technical definition: Article 339: Commission And Union Directions operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 339: commission and union directions, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Article 339: Commission And Union Directions is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 339: commission and union directions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Article 339**
- **presidential commission**
- **Union directions**
- **article**
- **commission**
- **union**
- **directions**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 339; define presidential commission, connect Union directions with article to explain the mechanism, and use commission for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 16 - Article 339's two clauses

Clause	Power	Precision
339(1)	President may appoint a commission at any time and was required to do so after ten years from commencement	examine Scheduled-Area administration and ST welfare
339(2)	Union may direct a State on drawing up/executing schemes specified as essential for ST welfare	scheme-specific welfare direction

- [FACT] The first Scheduled Areas and Scheduled Tribes Commission was chaired by U.N. Dhebar; a later commission was chaired by Dilip Singh Bhuria.
- [LIMIT] Article 339(2) welfare-scheme directions and Fifth Schedule paragraph 3 directions on Scheduled-Area administration are related but textually distinct.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ARTICLE 339: COMMISSION AND UNION DIRECTIONS

START / CONCEPT: ARTICLE 339: COMMISSION AND UNION DIRECTIONS

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 339 · presidential commission · Union directions · article · commission · union · directions

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for article 339: commission and union directions.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of article 339: commission and union directions.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise article 339: commission and union directions beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Article 339: Commission And Union Directions is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 339: commission and union directions.

SESSION 16 - ARTICLE 275(1): FISCAL SUPPORT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Article 275(1): Fiscal Support explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 275(1): fiscal support.

Technical definition: Article 275(1): Fiscal Support operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 275(1): fiscal support, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Article 275(1): Fiscal Support is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 275(1): fiscal support.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 275
- grants-in-aid
- tribal welfare
- article
- fiscal
- support

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 275; define grants-in-aid, connect tribal welfare with article to explain the mechanism, and use fiscal for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 17 - Constitutional finance chain

Parliament provides grants-in-aid
 |
 +--> ST welfare schemes approved by Government of India
 |
 +--> raising Scheduled-Area administration
 to the level of the rest of the State
 |
 v
 State implementation + constitutional accountability

- [FACT] Article 275(1) creates a dedicated constitutional grant route for specified tribal-welfare and Scheduled-Area administration needs.
- [ANALYSIS] Fiscal equalisation is essential because formal autonomy without administrative capacity can reproduce dependence.
- [LIMIT] A grant is not proof of devolution, rights recognition or outcomes.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ARTICLE 275(1): FISCAL SUPPORT

START / CONCEPT: ARTICLE 275(1): FISCAL SUPPORT
 |
 v
 EXACT TERMS: Article 275 · grants-in-aid · tribal welfare · article · fiscal · support
 |
 v
 MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for article 275(1): fiscal support.
 |
 v
 CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of article 275(1): fiscal support.
 |
 v
 UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise article 275(1): fiscal support beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.
 |
 v
 ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Article 275(1): Fiscal Support is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing article 275(1): fiscal support.

SESSION 17 - FIFTH SCHEDULE INSTITUTIONAL DASHBOARD

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Fifth Schedule Institutional Dashboard explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth schedule institutional dashboard.

Technical definition: Fifth Schedule Institutional Dashboard operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth schedule institutional dashboard, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Fifth Schedule Institutional Dashboard is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth schedule institutional dashboard.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Fifth Schedule
- Governor
- Tribes Advisory Council
- fifth
- schedule
- institutional
- dashboard

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fifth Schedule; define Governor, connect Tribes Advisory Council with fifth to explain the mechanism, and use schedule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 18 - Who does what?

Actor	Core role	Accountability risk
President/Union	declare areas; assent regulations; receive reports; give directions	distant supervision
Governor	report; refer to TAC; adapt laws; make regulations	opacity or dormancy
State government	day-to-day administration and implementation	conflict with extraction/revenue priorities
TAC	advice on referred welfare/advancement matters	weak agenda and non-binding advice
Gram Sabha under PESA/FRA	specified participatory, resource and rights functions	capacity, record and enforcement gaps

Visual 19 - Fifth Schedule performance equation

constitutional power
 x timely use
 x community participation
 x enforceable records
 x fiscal/administrative capacity
 = effective protection

- [ANALYSIS] A strong text can deliver weak protection if any multiplier approaches zero.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FIFTH SCHEDULE INSTITUTIONAL DASHBOARD

START / CONCEPT: FIFTH SCHEDULE INSTITUTIONAL DASHBOARD
 |
 v
 EXACT TERMS: Fifth Schedule · Governor · Tribes Advisory Council · fifth · schedule · institutional · dashboard
 |
 v
 MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for fifth schedule institutional dashboard.
 |
 v
 CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of fifth schedule institutional dashboard.
 |
 v
 UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise fifth schedule institutional dashboard beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.
 |
 v
 ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Fifth Schedule Institutional Dashboard is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth schedule institutional dashboard.

SESSION 18 - SIXTH SCHEDULE TERRITORIAL MAP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Sixth Schedule Territorial Map explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule territorial map.

Technical definition: Sixth Schedule Territorial Map operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule territorial map, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Sixth Schedule Territorial Map is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule territorial map.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sixth Schedule
- Autonomous District Council
- Governor
- sixth
- schedule
- territorial
- map

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with sixth to explain the mechanism, and use schedule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 20 - Four-State constitutional field

ASSAM	MEGHALAYA	TRIPURA	MIZORAM
autonomous districts and, where applicable, autonomous regions			
District / Regional Councils under the Sixth Schedule			

- [FACT] The Sixth Schedule operates only in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram.
- [LIMIT] Nagaland, Manipur and Arunachal Pradesh have other constitutional/statutory arrangements; do not add them to the Sixth Schedule list.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SIXTH SCHEDULE TERRITORIAL MAP

START / CONCEPT: SIXTH SCHEDULE TERRITORIAL MAP

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Sixth Schedule • Autonomous District Council • Governor • sixth • schedule • territorial • map

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for sixth schedule territorial map.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of sixth schedule territorial map.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise sixth schedule territorial map beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Sixth Schedule Territorial Map is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule territorial map.

SESSION 19 - AUTONOMOUS DISTRICT AND AUTONOMOUS REGION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Autonomous District And Autonomous Region explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing autonomous district and autonomous region.

Technical definition: Autonomous District And Autonomous Region operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing autonomous district and autonomous region, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

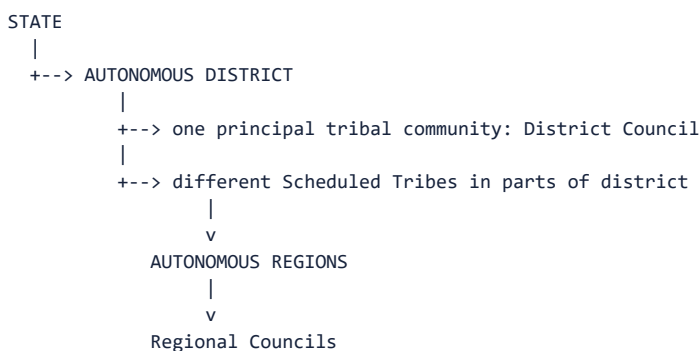
Autonomous District And Autonomous Region is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing autonomous district and autonomous region.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Sixth Schedule**
- **Autonomous District Council**
- **Governor**
- **autonomous**
- **district**
- **region**

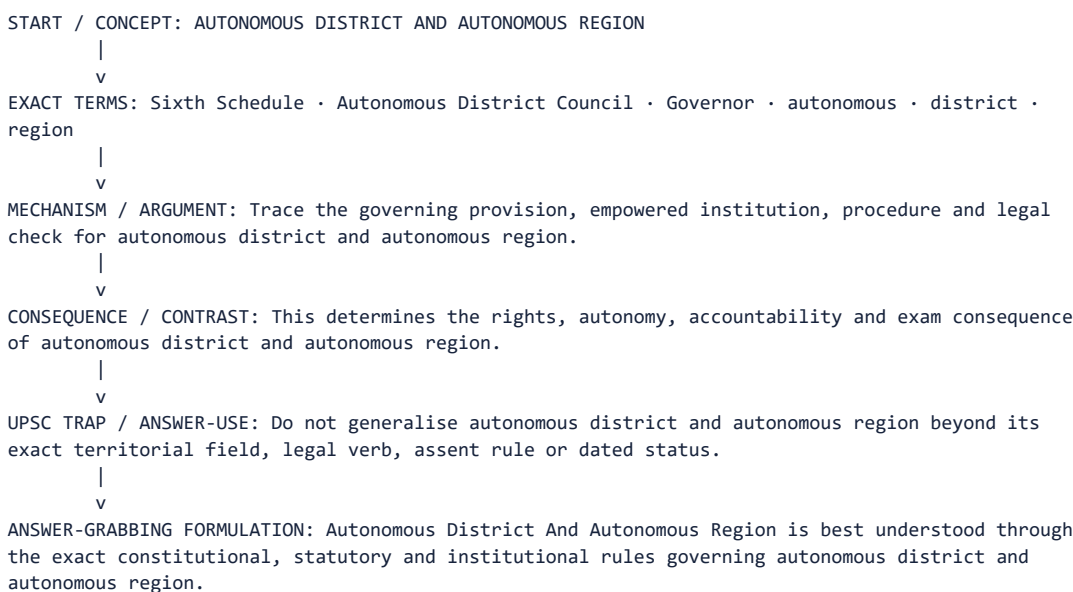
How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with autonomous to explain the mechanism, and use district for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 21 - Territorial nesting



- [FACT] Tribal areas in each Schedule part are administered as autonomous districts.
- [FACT] Where different STs inhabit an autonomous district, the Governor may divide it into autonomous regions.
- [LIMIT] An autonomous district remains within the State and subject to the Constitution; it is not a sovereign enclave.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - AUTONOMOUS DISTRICT AND AUTONOMOUS REGION



SESSION 20 - GOVERNOR'S TERRITORIAL ORGANISATION POWER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Governor'S Territorial Organisation Power explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's territorial organisation power.

Technical definition: Governor'S Territorial Organisation Power operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's territorial organisation power, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Governor'S Territorial Organisation Power is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's territorial organisation power.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Fifth Schedule**
- **Governor**
- **Tribes Advisory Council**
- **territorial**
- **organisation**
- **power**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Fifth Schedule; define Governor, connect Tribes Advisory Council with territorial to explain the mechanism, and use organisation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 22 - Reorganisation tools

Governor may by public notification	Constitutional effect
include/exclude an area	changes territorial reach
create a new autonomous district	adds a district unit
increase/decrease area	changes boundary
unite parts	consolidates units
define boundaries	settles territorial line
alter name	changes designation

- [FACT] The Schedule gives the Governor substantial territorial-organisation power, subject to its procedures.
- [LIMIT] Reorganisation is not equivalent to State creation under Articles 2-3.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - GOVERNOR'S TERRITORIAL ORGANISATION POWER

START / CONCEPT: GOVERNOR'S TERRITORIAL ORGANISATION POWER

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Fifth Schedule • Governor • Tribes Advisory Council • territorial • organisation • power

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for governor's territorial organisation power.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of governor's territorial organisation power.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise governor's territorial organisation power beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Governor's Territorial Organisation Power is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's territorial organisation power.

SESSION 21 - COUNCIL COMPOSITION: ORDINARY MODEL AND EXCEPTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Council Composition: Ordinary Model And Exceptions explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing council composition: ordinary model and exceptions.

Technical definition: Council Composition: Ordinary Model And Exceptions operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing council composition: ordinary model and exceptions, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Council Composition: Ordinary Model And Exceptions is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing council composition: ordinary model and exceptions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sixth Schedule
- Autonomous District Council
- Governor
- council
- composition
- ordinary
- model
- exceptions

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with council to explain the mechanism, and use composition for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 23 - Ordinary paragraph 2 model

DISTRICT COUNCIL: not more than 30 members
 |
 +--> not more than 4 nominated by Governor
 |
 +--> remainder elected on adult suffrage

elected term: ordinarily 5 years
 nominated tenure: pleasure of Governor

- [FACT] The ordinary model is "up to 30", not an invariable 30.
- [FACT] Special constitutional amendments create exceptions.

Visual 24 - Bodoland exception

Ordinary council	Bodoland Territorial Council special design
up to 30	46 members
up to 4 nominated	40 elected + 6 Governor-nominated
general paragraph 2 model	special Assam amendment architecture

- [CURRENT] Assam's official portal identifies BTC, Karbi Anglong and Dima Hasao/North Cachar Hills councils as its Sixth Schedule autonomous-council institutions.
- [LIMIT] Do not generalise BTC's composition or subject list to all councils.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - COUNCIL COMPOSITION: ORDINARY MODEL AND EXCEPTIONS

START / CONCEPT: COUNCIL COMPOSITION: ORDINARY MODEL AND EXCEPTIONS
 |
 v
 EXACT TERMS: Sixth Schedule · Autonomous District Council · Governor · council · composition ·
 ordinary · model · exceptions
 |
 v
 MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal
 check for council composition: ordinary model and exceptions.
 |
 v
 CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence
 of council composition: ordinary model and exceptions.
 |
 v
 UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise council composition: ordinary model and exceptions beyond
 its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.
 |
 v
 ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Council Composition: Ordinary Model And Exceptions is best understood
 through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing council composition:
 ordinary model and exceptions.

SESSION 22 - CURRENT INSTITUTIONAL EXAMPLES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Current Institutional Examples explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current institutional examples.

Technical definition: Current Institutional Examples operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current institutional examples, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Current Institutional Examples is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current institutional examples.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- institutional
- examples

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with institutional to explain the mechanism, and use examples for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 25 - State-wise council examples

State	Officially supported examples	Safe recall
Assam	Bodoland Territorial Council; Karbi Anglong Autonomous Council; Dima Hasao/North Cachar Hills Autonomous Council	special Assam amendments matter
Meghalaya	Khasi Hills, Jaintia Hills and Garo Hills ADCs	State department scrutinises council instruments before Governor route
Tripura	Tripura Tribal Areas Autonomous District Council	brought under Sixth Schedule from 1985
Mizoram	Chakma, Lai and Mara ADCs	distinct councils plus Article 371G State-level protection

- [LIMIT] Council names, rules and officeholders are institution-specific. The constitutional power map is common only to the extent the Schedule says so.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CURRENT INSTITUTIONAL EXAMPLES

START / CONCEPT: CURRENT INSTITUTIONAL EXAMPLES

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · institutional · examples

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for current institutional examples.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of current institutional examples.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise current institutional examples beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Current Institutional Examples is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current institutional examples.

SESSION 23 - SPECIAL ASSAM ARRANGEMENTS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Special Assam Arrangements explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing special assam arrangements.

Technical definition: Special Assam Arrangements operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing special assam arrangements, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Special Assam Arrangements is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing special assam arrangements.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- special
- assam
- arrangements

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with special to explain the mechanism, and use assam for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 26 - Assam's layered autonomy

SIXTH SCHEDULE ORDINARY POWERS

```
|
+--> paragraph 3A: additional subjects for
|    North Cachar Hills and Karbi Anglong councils
|
+--> paragraph 3B: enlarged subject allocation
|    for Bodoland Territorial Council
|
+--> Article 244A: Parliament may create
|    an autonomous State within Assam
|    with legislature and Council of Ministers
```

- [FACT] Paragraphs 3A and 3B are constitutionally embedded Assam-specific enlargements.
- [ANALYSIS] The Sixth Schedule is therefore asymmetric even within the four-State field.
- [LIMIT] Article 244A's autonomous-State possibility is distinct from the current legal status of an ADC and does not convert BTC, KAAC or the Dima Hasao council into a State.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SPECIAL ASSAM ARRANGEMENTS

START / CONCEPT: SPECIAL ASSAM ARRANGEMENTS

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · special · assam · arrangements

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for special assam arrangements.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of special assam arrangements.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise special assam arrangements beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Special Assam Arrangements is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing special assam arrangements.

SESSION 24 - SIXTH SCHEDULE LEGISLATIVE POWERS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Sixth Schedule Legislative Powers explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule legislative powers.

Technical definition: Sixth Schedule Legislative Powers operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule legislative powers, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Sixth Schedule Legislative Powers is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule legislative powers.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Sixth Schedule**
- **Autonomous District Council**
- **Governor**
- **sixth**
- **schedule**
- **legislative**
- **powers**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with sixth to explain the mechanism, and use schedule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 27 - Paragraph 3 subject map

Council law field	Core scope
land	allotment, occupation or use, other than reserved forest
forests	management of forests other than reserved forests
water	canals/watercourses for agriculture
cultivation	regulation of shifting cultivation
local institutions	village/town committees and administration
leadership	appointment/succession of chiefs or headmen
family/property custom	inheritance
personal/customary law	marriage, divorce and social customs

Visual 28 - Council-law validity chain

District / Regional Council passes law

↓

submitted to Governor

↓

NO EFFECT UNTIL GOVERNOR'S ASSENT

- [FACT] These powers are legislative in character and materially stronger than TAC advice.
- [LIMIT] The subject list is specified and bounded; a council does not possess the plenary competence of a State legislature.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SIXTH SCHEDULE LEGISLATIVE POWERS

START / CONCEPT: SIXTH SCHEDULE LEGISLATIVE POWERS

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Sixth Schedule • Autonomous District Council • Governor • sixth • schedule • legislative • powers

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for sixth schedule legislative powers.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of sixth schedule legislative powers.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise sixth schedule legislative powers beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Sixth Schedule Legislative Powers is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule legislative powers.

SESSION 25 - RESERVED FOREST AND MINERAL TRAPS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Reserved Forest And Mineral Traps explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing reserved forest and mineral traps.

Technical definition: Reserved Forest And Mineral Traps operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing reserved forest and mineral traps, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Reserved Forest And Mineral Traps is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing reserved forest and mineral traps.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- reserved
- forest
- mineral
- traps

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with reserved to explain the mechanism, and use forest for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 29 - What paragraph 3 does not give

Tempting claim	Correct position
council controls every forest	paragraph 3 excludes reserved forests
council owns all minerals	Schedule provides specified regulation/revenue arrangements, not blanket subsoil ownership
council may legislate on any State List subject	competence is schedule- and amendment-specific
Governor assent equals President assent	ordinary council laws use Governor assent; Fifth Schedule regulations use President assent

- [ANALYSIS] UPSC often converts one omitted adjective - "reserved" or "specified" - into the decisive close-option trap.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - RESERVED FOREST AND MINERAL TRAPS

START / CONCEPT: RESERVED FOREST AND MINERAL TRAPS

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · reserved · forest · mineral · traps

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for reserved forest and mineral traps.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of reserved forest and mineral traps.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise reserved forest and mineral traps beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Reserved Forest And Mineral Traps is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing reserved forest and mineral traps.

SESSION 26 - SIXTH SCHEDULE EXECUTIVE FUNCTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Sixth Schedule Executive Functions explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule executive functions.

Technical definition: Sixth Schedule Executive Functions operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule executive functions, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Sixth Schedule Executive Functions is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule executive functions.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sixth Schedule
- Autonomous District Council
- Governor
- sixth
- schedule
- executive
- functions

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with sixth to explain the mechanism, and use schedule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 30 - Local administration basket

District Council
 |
 +--> primary schools
 +--> dispensaries
 +--> markets and cattle pounds
 +--> ferries and fisheries
 +--> roads and specified transport/waterways
 +--> other entrusted State functions

- [FACT] Paragraph 6 authorises councils to establish, construct or manage specified local institutions and services.
- [FACT] The Governor may entrust additional functions relating to subjects such as agriculture, animal husbandry, community projects, cooperatives, social welfare and village planning.
- [LIMIT] Actual functional transfer depends on the applicable constitutional amendment, State-council arrangements, rules, staff and finance.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SIXTH SCHEDULE EXECUTIVE FUNCTIONS

START / CONCEPT: SIXTH SCHEDULE EXECUTIVE FUNCTIONS

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Sixth Schedule · Autonomous District Council · Governor · sixth · schedule · executive
 · functions

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for sixth schedule executive functions.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of sixth schedule executive functions.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise sixth schedule executive functions beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Sixth Schedule Executive Functions is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule executive functions.

SESSION 27 - SIXTH SCHEDULE JUDICIAL POWERS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Sixth Schedule Judicial Powers explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule judicial powers.

Technical definition: Sixth Schedule Judicial Powers operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule judicial powers, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

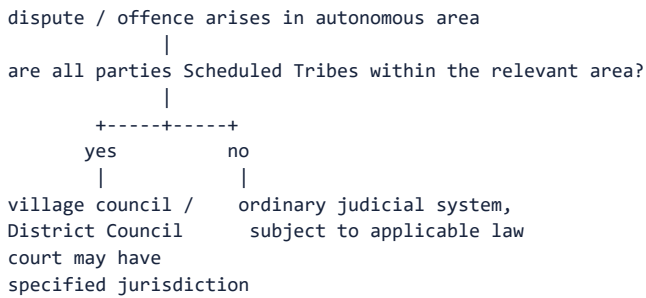
Sixth Schedule Judicial Powers is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule judicial powers.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sixth Schedule
- Autonomous District Council
- Governor
- sixth
- schedule
- judicial
- powers

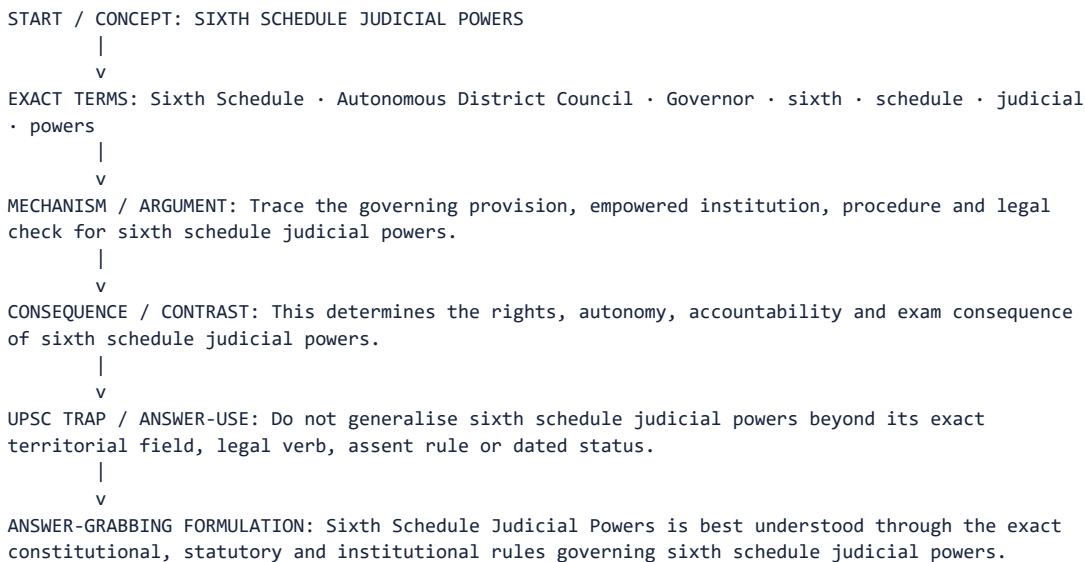
How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with sixth to explain the mechanism, and use schedule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 31 - Customary justice boundary



- [FACT] Paragraph 4 enables village councils or courts and appellate arrangements for specified cases within the tribal-party boundary.
- [FACT] The Governor frames/approves important jurisdictional and procedural rules under the Schedule.
- [LIMIT] These bodies are not unrestricted substitutes for constitutional High Courts or the entire criminal-justice system.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SIXTH SCHEDULE JUDICIAL POWERS



SESSION 28 - SIXTH SCHEDULE FISCAL POWERS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Sixth Schedule Fiscal Powers explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule fiscal powers.

Technical definition: Sixth Schedule Fiscal Powers operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule fiscal powers, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Sixth Schedule Fiscal Powers is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule fiscal powers.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Sixth Schedule**
- **Autonomous District Council**

- Governor
- sixth
- schedule
- fiscal
- powers

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with sixth to explain the mechanism, and use schedule for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 32 - Revenue basket

Power	Examples under the Schedule
land revenue	assessment and collection
taxes	lands/buildings; professions/trades/callings/employment; animals, vehicles and boats
local levies	entry of goods into markets; tolls; taxes for maintenance of schools, dispensaries or roads
markets and services	fees and local-service revenue under valid law
funds	District and Regional Funds with prescribed accounting/audit

- [FACT] Councils have constitutionally recognised revenue powers that a Fifth Schedule TAC does not possess.
- [LIMIT] The exact levy must fit the Schedule and valid council law; "fiscal autonomy" does not mean immunity from audit, State law or constitutional limits.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SIXTH SCHEDULE FISCAL POWERS

START / CONCEPT: SIXTH SCHEDULE FISCAL POWERS

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Sixth Schedule • Autonomous District Council • Governor • sixth • schedule • fiscal • powers

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for sixth schedule fiscal powers.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of sixth schedule fiscal powers.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise sixth schedule fiscal powers beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Sixth Schedule Fiscal Powers is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing sixth schedule fiscal powers.

SESSION 29 - MINERAL ROYALTY ARRANGEMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mineral Royalty Arrangement explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing mineral royalty arrangement.

Technical definition: Mineral Royalty Arrangement operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing mineral royalty arrangement, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mineral Royalty Arrangement is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing mineral royalty arrangement.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Article 244**
- **Scheduled Areas**
- **tribal governance**
- **mineral**
- **royalty**
- **arrangement**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with mineral to explain the mechanism, and use royalty for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 33 - Paragraph 9 flow

```
State grants mineral licence / lease
      |
      v
royalty accrues
      |
      v
agreed share paid to District Council
      |
      v
dispute on share
      |
      v
Governor determines under Schedule mechanism
```

- [FACT] The Schedule contemplates a share of mineral royalties for the District Council.
- [ANALYSIS] Revenue sharing can internalise some local costs but cannot substitute for rights compliance, environmental appraisal or rehabilitation.
- [LIMIT] A royalty share is not ownership of all minerals and is not community consent.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - MINERAL ROYALTY ARRANGEMENT

```
START / CONCEPT: MINERAL ROYALTY ARRANGEMENT
      |
      v
EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · mineral · royalty · arrangement
      |
      v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal
check for mineral royalty arrangement.
      |
      v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence
of mineral royalty arrangement.
      |
      v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise mineral royalty arrangement beyond its exact territorial
field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.
      |
      v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mineral Royalty Arrangement is best understood through the exact
constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing mineral royalty arrangement.
```

SESSION 30 - APPLICATION OF PARLIAMENT AND STATE LAWS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Application Of Parliament And State Laws explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing application of parliament and state laws.

Technical definition: Application Of Parliament And State Laws operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing application of parliament and state laws, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Application Of Parliament And State Laws is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing application of parliament and state laws.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- application
- parliament
- laws

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with application to explain the mechanism, and use parliament for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 34 - State-specific legal filters

State field	Schedule technique
Assam	special rules on application of State/parliamentary laws to autonomous districts and regions
Meghalaya	distinct paragraph 12A route
Tripura	distinct paragraph 12AA route
Mizoram	distinct paragraph 12B route

- [FACT] The Sixth Schedule contains separate State-specific provisions on whether and how laws apply.
- [LIMIT] Avoid the oversimplified sentence "Central and State laws do not apply unless the council agrees." The correct answer must identify that applicability, modification and notification rules vary by State and subject.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - APPLICATION OF PARLIAMENT AND STATE LAWS

START / CONCEPT: APPLICATION OF PARLIAMENT AND STATE LAWS

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · application · parliament · laws

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for application of parliament and state laws.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of application of parliament and state laws.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise application of parliament and state laws beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Application Of Parliament And State Laws is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing application of parliament and state laws.

SESSION 31 - GOVERNOR'S CHECKS ON COUNCILS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Governor'S Checks On Councils explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's checks on councils.

Technical definition: Governor'S Checks On Councils operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's checks on councils, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

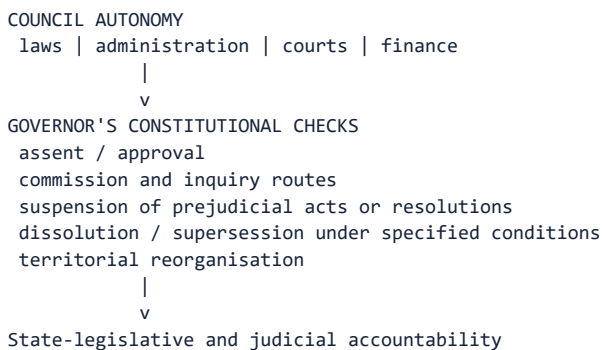
Governor'S Checks On Councils is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's checks on councils.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Sixth Schedule**
- **Autonomous District Council**
- **Governor**
- **checks**
- **councils**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with checks to explain the mechanism, and use councils for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 35 - Autonomy with constitutional brakes



- [FACT] The Schedule authorises gubernatorial intervention through specified procedures when council action threatens safety/public order or when administration requires inquiry and reconstitution.
- [LIMIT] These are conditioned constitutional controls, not a free-standing power to erase autonomy for political convenience.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - GOVERNOR'S CHECKS ON COUNCILS

START / CONCEPT: GOVERNOR'S CHECKS ON COUNCILS

|

↓

EXACT TERMS: Sixth Schedule · Autonomous District Council · Governor · checks · councils

|

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for governor's checks on councils.

|

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of governor's checks on councils.

|

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise governor's checks on councils beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Governor'S Checks On Councils is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing governor's checks on councils.

SESSION 32 - PRESIDENT'S ROLE IN THE SIXTH SCHEDULE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: President'S Role In The Sixth Schedule explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing president's role in the sixth schedule.

Technical definition: President'S Role In The Sixth Schedule operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing president's role in the sixth schedule, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

President'S Role In The Sixth Schedule is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing president's role in the sixth schedule.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sixth Schedule
- Autonomous District Council
- Governor
- president
- role
- sixth
- schedule

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with president to explain the mechanism, and use role for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 36 - Do not import the Fifth Schedule assent rule

Function	Primary constitutional actor
ordinary council law assent	Governor
council rules/regulations where Schedule requires	Governor approval/assent
Article 275(1) grants	Union/Parliamentary constitutional finance
amendment of Sixth Schedule	Parliament under paragraph 21, treated as not an Article 368 amendment for that purpose
routine approval of every ADC decision	not the President

- [FACT] The President is not the routine assent authority for Sixth Schedule council laws.
- [LIMIT] Union legislation, constitutional finance and parliamentary amendment remain important; autonomy is nested within the Union-State Constitution.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PRESIDENT'S ROLE IN THE SIXTH SCHEDULE

START / CONCEPT: PRESIDENT'S ROLE IN THE SIXTH SCHEDULE

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Sixth Schedule · Autonomous District Council · Governor · president · role · sixth · schedule

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for president's role in the sixth schedule.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of president's role in the sixth schedule.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise president's role in the sixth schedule beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: President's Role In The Sixth Schedule is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing president's role in the sixth schedule.

SESSION 33 - FIFTH VERSUS SIXTH SCHEDULE: EXACT COMPARISON

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Fifth Versus Sixth Schedule: Exact Comparison explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth versus sixth schedule: exact comparison.

Technical definition: Fifth Versus Sixth Schedule: Exact Comparison operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth versus sixth schedule: exact comparison, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Fifth Versus Sixth Schedule: Exact Comparison is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth versus sixth schedule: exact comparison.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sixth Schedule
- Autonomous District Council
- Governor
- fifth
- sixth
- schedule
- comparison

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sixth Schedule; define Autonomous District Council, connect Governor with fifth to explain the mechanism, and use sixth for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 37 - Master comparison matrix

Dimension	Fifth Schedule	Sixth Schedule
Article	244(1)	244(2)
territory	notified Scheduled Areas in 10 States	tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram
territorial status-maker	President declares Scheduled Area	Constitution lists areas; Governor organises/reorganises districts/regions
core theory	protective supervision	territorial self-government
main representative body	TAC, advisory	elected District/Regional Council
law-making	Governor adapts laws/makes regulations	councils legislate on specified subjects
assent	President for Governor's regulations	Governor for council laws
executive power	State continues; Union directions	State authority continues; councils manage specified functions
courts	ordinary system; special laws may operate	village/council courts for specified tribal-party cases
taxation	no TAC taxation power	councils assess land revenue and specified taxes
local-government statute	PESA applies	PESA does not apply
autonomy ceiling	no elected territorial legislature in Schedule itself	substantial but subject-specific and supervised

Visual 38 - One-line memory contrast

FIFTH = AREA + GOVERNOR/PRESIDENT + TAC + PESA

SIXTH = DISTRICT/REGION + ELECTED COUNCIL + LAWS/COURTS/TAXES

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FIFTH VERSUS SIXTH SCHEDULE: EXACT COMPARISON

START / CONCEPT: FIFTH VERSUS SIXTH SCHEDULE: EXACT COMPARISON

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Sixth Schedule · Autonomous District Council · Governor · fifth · sixth · schedule · comparison

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for fifth versus sixth schedule: exact comparison.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of fifth versus sixth schedule: exact comparison.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise fifth versus sixth schedule: exact comparison beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Fifth Versus Sixth Schedule: Exact Comparison is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fifth versus sixth schedule: exact comparison.

SESSION 34 - FOUR SYSTEMS THAT MUST NOT BE COLLAPSED

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Four Systems That Must Not Be Collapsed explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing four systems that must not be collapsed.

Technical definition: Four Systems That Must Not Be Collapsed operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing four systems that must not be collapsed, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Four Systems That Must Not Be Collapsed is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing four systems that must not be collapsed.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Article 244**
- **Scheduled Areas**
- **tribal governance**
- **four**
- **systems**
- **collapsed**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with four to explain the mechanism, and use systems for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 39 - Constitutional differentiation grid

System	Source	Territorial unit	Core institution
ordinary Panchayats	Part IX	rural local area	Gram Sabha + three-tier PRIs
PESA	1996 Act applying modified Part IX	Fifth Schedule Scheduled Areas	habitation-based Gram Sabha + PRIs
Sixth Schedule	Constitution	autonomous district/region in four States	District/Regional Council
Article 371 family	Part XXI State-specific provisions	named State	Governor responsibility, committees, customary/resource protections or regional boards depending Article

- [FACT] Article 243M excludes Scheduled Areas and tribal areas from automatic Part IX application.
- [FACT] PESA extends Part IX only to Fifth Schedule areas, with exceptions and modifications.
- [LIMIT] Article 371A/371G customary-law and land/resource protections do not make Nagaland or all Mizoram a Sixth Schedule council system.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUR SYSTEMS THAT MUST NOT BE COLLAPSED

START / CONCEPT: FOUR SYSTEMS THAT MUST NOT BE COLLAPSED

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · four · systems · collapsed

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for four systems that must not be collapsed.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of four systems that must not be collapsed.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise four systems that must not be collapsed beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Four Systems That Must Not Be Collapsed is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing four systems that must not be collapsed.

SESSION 35 - WHY PESA WAS ENACTED

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Why PESA Was Enacted explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing why pesa was enacted.

Technical definition: Why PESA Was Enacted operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing why pesa was enacted, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Why PESA Was Enacted is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing why pesa was enacted.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- PESA
- Gram Sabha
- Scheduled Areas
- was
- enacted

How to use them: Frame the answer through PESA; define Gram Sabha, connect Scheduled Areas with was to explain the mechanism, and use enacted for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 40 - From protected subject to self-governing participant

FIFTH SCHEDULE

protective administration

|

Part IX initially excluded by Article 243M

|

Bhuria Committee approach

|

PESA, 1996

|

custom + habitation village + Gram Sabha powers

|

development decisions become participatory and locally accountable

- [FACT] PESA requires State Panchayat law in Scheduled Areas to conform to customary law, social and religious practices and traditional management of community resources.
- [ANALYSIS] It adds a self-rule logic to a Schedule otherwise centred on the Governor, State and Union.

- [LIMIT] PESA operates through State legislation and implementation; central enactment alone does not create identical institutional practice everywhere.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - WHY PESA WAS ENACTED

START / CONCEPT: WHY PESA WAS ENACTED

|
v

EXACT TERMS: PESA • Gram Sabha • Scheduled Areas • was • enacted

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for why pesa was enacted.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of why pesa was enacted.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise why pesa was enacted beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Why PESA Was Enacted is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing why pesa was enacted.

SESSION 36 - PESA VILLAGE AND GRAM SABHA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: PESA Village And Gram Sabha explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa village and gram sabha.

Technical definition: PESA Village And Gram Sabha operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa village and gram sabha, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

PESA Village And Gram Sabha is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa village and gram sabha.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- PESA
- Gram Sabha
- Scheduled Areas
- village
- gram
- sabha

How to use them: Frame the answer through PESA; define Gram Sabha, connect Scheduled Areas with village to explain the mechanism, and use gram for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 41 - Habitation-based democratic unit

hamlet / habitation / group of habitations
 |
 community managing affairs by traditions and customs
 |
 v
 PESA VILLAGE
 |
 all persons on village-level electoral rolls
 |
 v
 GRAM SABHA

- [FACT] PESA's village conception is deliberately closer to lived community than a large administrative Gram Panchayat boundary.
- [FACT] Every Gram Sabha is competent to safeguard traditions, customs, cultural identity, community resources and customary dispute resolution.
- [LIMIT] Custom is constitutionally relevant but cannot be treated as immune from Fundamental Rights, statute or judicial review.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PESA VILLAGE AND GRAM SABHA

START / CONCEPT: PESA VILLAGE AND GRAM SABHA
 |
 v
 EXACT TERMS: PESA · Gram Sabha · Scheduled Areas · village · gram · sabha
 |
 v
 MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for pesa village and gram sabha.
 |
 v
 CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of pesa village and gram sabha.
 |
 v
 UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise pesa village and gram sabha beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.
 |
 v
 ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: PESA Village And Gram Sabha is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa village and gram sabha.

SESSION 37 - PESA POWER VERBS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: PESA Power Verbs explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa power verbs.

Technical definition: PESA Power Verbs operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa power verbs, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

PESA Power Verbs is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa power verbs.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **PESA**
- **Gram Sabha**
- **Scheduled Areas**
- **power**
- **verbs**

How to use them: Frame the answer through PESA; define Gram Sabha, connect Scheduled Areas with power to explain the mechanism, and use verbs for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 42 - Exact statutory verb matrix

Verb	Object	Holder/level under section 4
approve	social/economic development plans, programmes and projects before village-Panchayat implementation	Gram Sabha
identify/select	beneficiaries under poverty alleviation and other programmes	Gram Sabha
certify	utilisation of funds for relevant plans/programmes/projects	Gram Sabha certification obtained by village Panchayat
consult	land acquisition and resettlement/rehabilitation in Scheduled Areas	Gram Sabha or Panchayat at appropriate level
manage	planning and management of minor water bodies	Panchayat at appropriate level
recommend mandatorily	prospecting licence/mining lease for minor minerals	Gram Sabha or Panchayat at appropriate level
recommend mandatorily	concession for minor-mineral exploitation by auction	Panchayat at appropriate level
own / regulate / control / restore	specified resources and institutions	State law must endow Gram Sabha and Panchayats at appropriate level as section 4(m) states

Visual 43 - Section 4(m) substantive basket

ownership of minor forest produce
control of village markets
regulate money-lending to STs
regulate/restrict intoxicants
prevent land alienation + restore unlawfully alienated land
control social-sector institutions and functionaries
control local plans and resources, including tribal sub-plans

- [LIMIT] Attribute each power to the statutory formulation - "Gram Sabha or Panchayats at the appropriate level" where relevant - rather than assigning everything exclusively to one Gram Sabha.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PESA POWER VERBS

START / CONCEPT: PESA POWER VERBS

|

v

EXACT TERMS: PESA • Gram Sabha • Scheduled Areas • power • verbs

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for pesa power verbs.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of pesa power verbs.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise pesa power verbs beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: PESA Power Verbs is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa power verbs.

SESSION 38 - CONSULTATION, RECOMMENDATION AND APPROVAL ARE DIFFERENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Consultation, Recommendation And Approval Are Different explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing consultation, recommendation and approval are different.

Technical definition: Consultation, Recommendation And Approval Are Different operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing consultation, recommendation and approval are different, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Consultation, Recommendation And Approval Are Different is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing consultation, recommendation and approval are different.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Article 244**
- **Scheduled Areas**
- **tribal governance**
- **consultation**
- **recommendation**
- **approval**
- **different**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with consultation to explain the mechanism, and use recommendation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 44 - Legal intensity ladder

INFORMATION

<

CONSULTATION

views must be sought and considered

<

PRIOR / MANDATORY RECOMMENDATION

specified recommendation is a precondition

<

APPROVAL

plan/programme/project needs Gram Sabha approval before local implementation

- [FACT] PESA uses consultation before land acquisition and resettlement/rehabilitation.
- [FACT] It makes recommendations mandatory before specified minor-mineral licences/leases and concessions.
- [FACT] It requires Gram Sabha approval of local development plans, programmes and projects before village-Panchayat implementation.
- [FACT] The central Act keeps actual planning and implementation of acquisition-linked development projects coordinated at the State level.
- [LIMIT] These provisions do not amount to a universal consent/veto rule for every acquisition, major mineral, forest clearance or infrastructure project.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CONSULTATION, RECOMMENDATION AND APPROVAL ARE DIFFERENT

START / CONCEPT: CONSULTATION, RECOMMENDATION AND APPROVAL ARE DIFFERENT

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · consultation · recommendation · approval · different

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for consultation, recommendation and approval are different.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of consultation, recommendation and approval are different.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise consultation, recommendation and approval are different beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Consultation, Recommendation And Approval Are Different is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing consultation, recommendation and approval are different.

SESSION 39 - PESA LAND AND MINOR-MINERAL DECISION FLOW

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: PESA Land And Minor-Mineral Decision Flow explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa land and minor-mineral decision flow.

Technical definition: PESA Land And Minor-Mineral Decision Flow operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa land and minor-mineral decision flow, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

PESA Land And Minor-Mineral Decision Flow is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa land and minor-mineral decision flow.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- PESA
- Gram Sabha
- Scheduled Areas
- land
- minor
- mineral
- decision
- flow

How to use them: Frame the answer through PESA; define Gram Sabha, connect Scheduled Areas with land to explain the mechanism, and use minor for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 45 - Project-stage precision

PROPOSED ACTIVITY IN FIFTH SCHEDULE AREA

```
|
+--> land acquisition / R&R
|      -> consult GS or appropriate Panchayat
|
+--> minor-mineral prospecting licence / mining lease
|      -> mandatory prior recommendation
|
+--> minor-mineral concession by auction
|      -> prior recommendation of appropriate Panchayat
|
+--> forest land / recognised forest rights
|      -> FRA process + forest/environment law
```

- [ANALYSIS] Correct sequencing prevents a common answer error: using one PESA verb to describe a legally different stage.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PESA LAND AND MINOR-MINERAL DECISION FLOW

START / CONCEPT: PESA LAND AND MINOR-MINERAL DECISION FLOW

|
v

EXACT TERMS: PESA · Gram Sabha · Scheduled Areas · land · minor · mineral · decision · flow

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for pesa land and minor-mineral decision flow.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of pesa land and minor-mineral decision flow.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise pesa land and minor-mineral decision flow beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: PESA Land And Minor-Mineral Decision Flow is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa land and minor-mineral decision flow.

SESSION 40 - PESA REPRESENTATION AND RESERVATIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: PESA Representation And Reservations explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa representation and reservations.

Technical definition: PESA Representation And Reservations operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa representation and reservations, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

PESA Representation And Reservations is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa representation and reservations.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- PESA
- Gram Sabha
- Scheduled Areas
- representation
- reservations

How to use them: Frame the answer through PESA; define Gram Sabha, connect Scheduled Areas with representation to explain the mechanism, and use reservations for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 46 - Scheduled-Area representation safeguards

Feature	PESA rule
ST seat reservation	not less than one-half of total seats at every Panchayat level in Scheduled Areas
chairpersons	all chairperson seats at all levels reserved for STs
unrepresented STs	State may nominate at intermediate/district level, within statutory ceiling
higher-level design	State law must not let higher Panchayat assume powers of lower Panchayat or Gram Sabha

- [ANALYSIS] PESA combines territorial self-government, substantive representation and subsidiarity.
- [FACT] PESA also asks State legislation to endeavour to follow the Sixth Schedule pattern while designing district-level administrative arrangements in Scheduled Areas.
- [LIMIT] Reservation supplies presence; actual influence still depends on meeting design, records, information and control over staff/resources.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PESA REPRESENTATION AND RESERVATIONS

START / CONCEPT: PESA REPRESENTATION AND RESERVATIONS

|
v

EXACT TERMS: PESA • Gram Sabha • Scheduled Areas • representation • reservations

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for pesa representation and reservations.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of pesa representation and reservations.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise pesa representation and reservations beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: PESA Representation And Reservations is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa representation and reservations.

SESSION 41 - FRA RELATIONSHIP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: FRA Relationship explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fra relationship.

Technical definition: FRA Relationship operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fra relationship, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

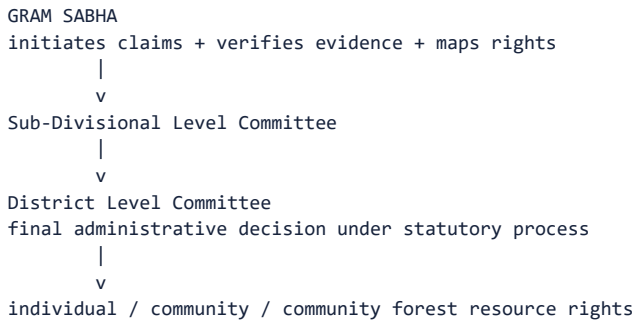
FRA Relationship is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fra relationship.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FRA
- forest rights
- Gram Sabha
- relationship

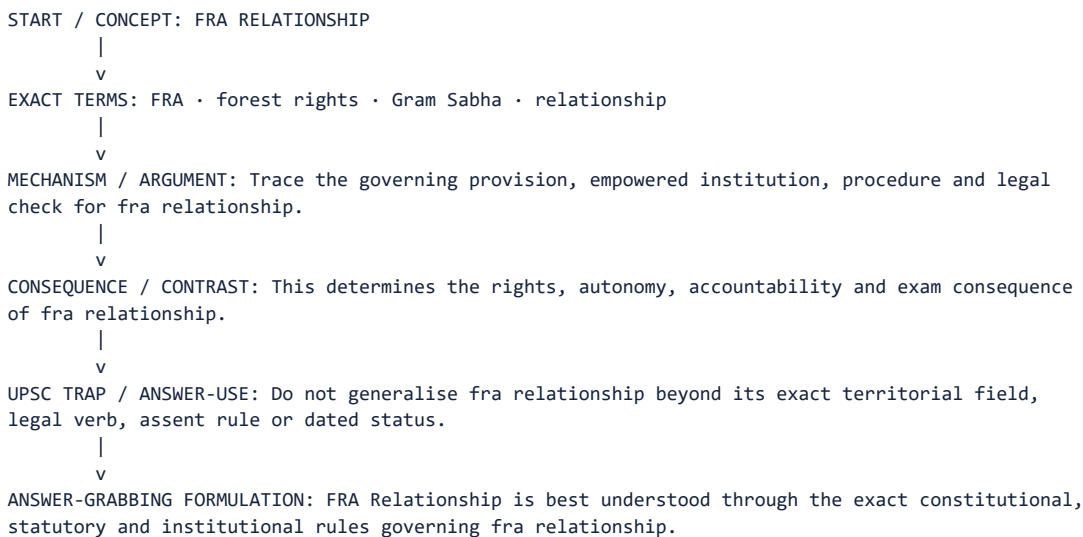
How to use them: Frame the answer through FRA; define forest rights, connect Gram Sabha with relationship to explain the mechanism, and close with the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 47 - Rights-recognition ladder



- [FACT] FRA section 6 makes the Gram Sabha the authority that initiates determination of individual and community forest rights.
- [FACT] Community Forest Resource rights include the right to protect, regenerate, conserve or manage a traditionally protected community forest resource.
- [FACT] Section 5 assigns holders/Gram Sabha duties to protect wildlife, forests and biodiversity, preserve catchments and ensure decisions on access are taken through regulated community processes.
- [LIMIT] FRA recognition does not transfer all forest administration or mineral ownership to the Gram Sabha.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FRA RELATIONSHIP



SESSION 42 - PESA AND FRA: OVERLAP WITHOUT MERGER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: PESA And FRA: Overlap Without Merger explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa and fra: overlap without merger.

Technical definition: PESA And FRA: Overlap Without Merger operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa and fra: overlap without merger, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

PESA And FRA: Overlap Without Merger is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa and fra: overlap without merger.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- PESA
- Gram Sabha

- **Scheduled Areas**
- **fra**
- **overlap**
- **without**
- **merger**

How to use them: Frame the answer through PESA; define Gram Sabha, connect Scheduled Areas with fra to explain the mechanism, and use overlap for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 48 - Two statutes, two primary functions

PESA	FRA
local self-government in Fifth Schedule areas	recognition and vesting of forest rights
customary institutions and community resources	individual, community and CFR rights
specified approval/consultation/recommendation powers	claims, title and conservation responsibilities
minor forest produce ownership route in State law	ownership/access/use/disposal rights over MFP under statutory rights framework

Visual 49 - Combined governance chain

PESA: WHO PARTICIPATES AND WITH WHAT LOCAL POWER?

+

FRA: WHO HOLDS WHICH FOREST RIGHT?

+

forest / environment / mining / land law

|

v

lawful project or conservation decision

- [ANALYSIS] PESA and FRA are complementary but not interchangeable. A project may satisfy one and still fail another legal requirement.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PESA AND FRA: OVERLAP WITHOUT MERGER

START / CONCEPT: PESA AND FRA: OVERLAP WITHOUT MERGER

|

v

EXACT TERMS: PESA • Gram Sabha • Scheduled Areas • fra • overlap • without • merger

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for pesa and fra: overlap without merger.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of pesa and fra: overlap without merger.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise pesa and fra: overlap without merger beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: PESA And FRA: Overlap Without Merger is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing pesa and fra: overlap without merger.

SESSION 43 - LAND ALIENATION: PREVENTION AND RESTORATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Land Alienation: Prevention And Restoration explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing land alienation: prevention and restoration.

Technical definition: Land Alienation: Prevention And Restoration operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing land alienation: prevention and restoration, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

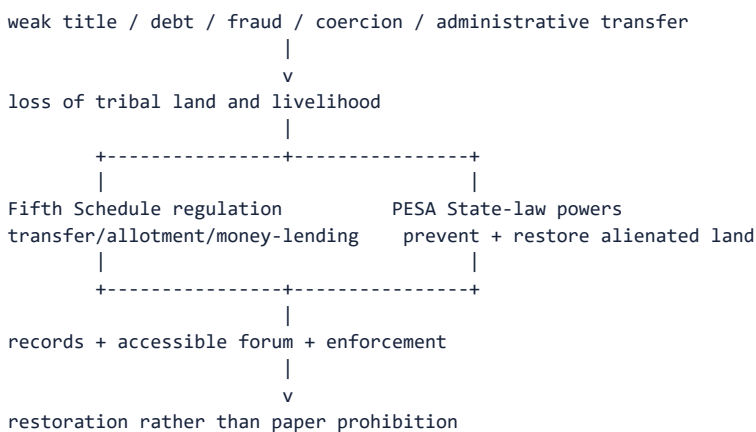
Land Alienation: Prevention And Restoration is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing land alienation: prevention and restoration.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- land
- alienation
- prevention
- restoration

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with land to explain the mechanism, and use alienation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 50 - Alienation control cycle



- [ANALYSIS] A prohibition without updated records, legal aid and restitution machinery can freeze illegality rather than reverse it.
- [LIMIT] The applicable land-transfer regulation is State-specific; never assume identical wording or remedies across all 10 States.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LAND ALIENATION: PREVENTION AND RESTORATION

START / CONCEPT: LAND ALIENATION: PREVENTION AND RESTORATION

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · land · alienation · prevention · restoration

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for land alienation: prevention and restoration.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of land alienation: prevention and restoration.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise land alienation: prevention and restoration beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Land Alienation: Prevention And Restoration is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing land alienation: prevention and restoration.

SESSION 44 - SAMATHA (1997): HOLDING AND BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Samatha (1997): Holding And Boundary explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing Samatha (1997): holding and boundary.

Technical definition: Samatha (1997): Holding And Boundary operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing Samatha (1997): holding and boundary, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Samatha (1997): Holding And Boundary is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing Samatha (1997): holding and boundary.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Samatha (1997)
- land transfer
- mining leases
- holding
- boundary

How to use them: Frame the answer through Samatha (1997); define land transfer, connect mining leases with holding to explain the mechanism, and use boundary for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 51 - Case-use discipline

Element	Safe proposition
case	<i>Samatha (1997) v. State of Andhra Pradesh (1997)</i>
legal setting	Andhra Pradesh Scheduled Areas Land Transfer Regulation read with Fifth Schedule
majority holding	State grants/leases of land in Scheduled Areas to non-tribal private mining companies were invalid under that regulatory setting
constitutional significance	State acts as trustee; anti-alienation purpose receives a protective reading
qualification	later treatment, including the BALCO context, prevents presenting the Andhra Pradesh regulation-based holding as an automatic nationwide rule for every State

- [LIMIT] Do not convert *Samatha (1997)* into the sentence "all mining by every private company in every Scheduled Area is constitutionally prohibited." Identify the State regulation, land status, lessee and later legal context.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SAMATHA (1997): HOLDING AND BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: SAMATHA (1997): HOLDING AND BOUNDARY

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Samatha (1997) • land transfer • mining leases • holding • boundary

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for Samatha (1997): holding and boundary.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of Samatha (1997): holding and boundary.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise Samatha (1997): holding and boundary beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Samatha (1997): Holding And Boundary is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing Samatha (1997): holding and boundary.

SESSION 45 - ORISSA MINING CORPORATION (2013) / NIYAMGIRI

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / Niyamgiri explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / niyamgiri.

Technical definition: Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / Niyamgiri operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / niyamgiri, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / Niyamgiri is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / niyamgiri.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Niyamgiri
- Gram Sabha
- forest rights
- orissa
- mining
- corporation

How to use them: Frame the answer through Niyamgiri; define Gram Sabha, connect forest rights with orissa to explain the mechanism, and use mining for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 52 - Supreme Court's actual process

FRA individual/community/cultural/religious claims

|

v

Gram Sabhas consider and decide those claims
with State/MoTA assistance and judicial observer

|

v

decisions communicated through State to MoEF

|

v

MoEF takes final Stage-II forest-clearance decision
in light of Gram Sabha decisions

- [FACT] The Court held that Gram Sabhas had a role in safeguarding customary and religious rights under FRA read with PESA.
- [FACT] It directed consideration of whether mining would affect worship of Niyam Raja and other community, individual, cultural and religious claims.
- [FACT] The final Stage-II clearance decision remained with MoEF, to be taken in light of Gram Sabha decisions.
- [LIMIT] The judgment is not authority for an unqualified Gram Sabha veto over every mine or ordinary EIA hearing.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ORISSA MINING CORPORATION (2013) / NIYAMGIRI

START / CONCEPT: ORISSA MINING CORPORATION (2013) / NIYAMGIRI

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Niyamgiri · Gram Sabha · forest rights · orissa · mining · corporation

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / niyamgiri.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / niyamgiri.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / niyamgiri beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / Niyamgiri is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) / niyamgiri.

SESSION 46 - DEVELOPMENT, MINING AND DISPLACEMENT CONFLICT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Development, Mining And Displacement Conflict explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing development, mining and displacement conflict.

Technical definition: Development, Mining And Displacement Conflict operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing development, mining and displacement conflict, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Development, Mining And Displacement Conflict is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing development, mining and displacement conflict.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- development
- mining
- displacement
- conflict

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with development to explain the mechanism, and use mining for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 53 - Rights-impact chain

mineral / infrastructure proposal
|
land take + forest diversion + ecological change
|
livelihood + culture + sacred landscape + settlement impact
|
PESA + FRA + land-transfer law + acquisition/R&R + environment law
|
participatory evidence and reasoned decision
|
avoid | redesign | condition | compensate/rehabilitate | reject

Visual 54 - Claim-evidence-analysis-qualification example

Step	Answer-writing content
claim	participation changes what counts as project impact
named evidence	<i>Orissa Mining Corporation (2013)</i> required Gram Sabha determination of FRA-linked cultural/religious claims
analysis	sacred and community relationships cannot be reduced to market compensation
qualification	MoEF retained the final clearance function; other statutory routes still applied

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - DEVELOPMENT, MINING AND DISPLACEMENT CONFLICT

START / CONCEPT: DEVELOPMENT, MINING AND DISPLACEMENT CONFLICT
|
v
EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · development · mining · displacement · conflict
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for development, mining and displacement conflict.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of development, mining and displacement conflict.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise development, mining and displacement conflict beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Development, Mining And Displacement Conflict is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing development, mining and displacement conflict.

SESSION 47 - FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS AND DPSP INTERFACE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Fundamental Rights And Dpsp Interface explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fundamental rights and dpsp interface.

Technical definition: Fundamental Rights And Dpsp Interface operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fundamental rights and dpsp interface, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Fundamental Rights And Dpsp Interface is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fundamental rights and dpsp interface.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- fundamental
- rights
- dpsp
- interface

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with fundamental to explain the mechanism, and use rights for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 55 - Constitutional rights web

Provision	Scheduled/tribal-area application
Article 14	non-arbitrary classification and administration
Article 19	movement, residence, occupation subject to valid protections/restrictions
Article 21	dignity, livelihood, fair procedure and cultural conditions of life
Articles 25-26	religious practice and sacred-landscape claims, as applied in Niyamgiri
Article 29(1)	conserve distinct language, script or culture
Article 46	promote educational/economic interests of STs and protect from social injustice/exploitation
Article 300A	deprivation of property only by authority of law

- [ANALYSIS] The Schedules operationalise substantive equality but do not displace Part III.
- [LIMIT] No single Article automatically decides a project; the correct answer integrates rights, enabling statutes, public purpose and proportionality.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS AND DPSP INTERFACE

START / CONCEPT: FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS AND DPSP INTERFACE

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · fundamental · rights · dpdp · interface

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for fundamental rights and dpdp interface.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of fundamental rights and dpdp interface.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise fundamental rights and dpdp interface beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Fundamental Rights And Dpdp Interface is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing fundamental rights and dpdp interface.

SESSION 48 - ACCOUNTABILITY ARCHITECTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Accountability Architecture explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing accountability architecture.

Technical definition: Accountability Architecture operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing accountability architecture, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Accountability Architecture is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing accountability architecture.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- accountability
- architecture

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with accountability to explain the mechanism, and use architecture for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 56 - Five-accountability model

ELECTORAL	council / Panchayat representatives
LEGAL	Constitution, PESA, FRA, land and environment law
FISCAL	grants, council funds, audit and utilisation records
ADMINISTRATIVE	Governor/State/Union reporting and directions
SOCIAL	Gram Sabha, public records, grievance and community monitoring

Visual 57 - Common accountability failures

Failure	Institutional effect
TAC agenda controlled from above	advice becomes ceremonial
Governor reports not transparent	Union supervision lacks public evidence
council law awaits assent without timelines	autonomy becomes administrative delay
parallel departments retain staff/funds	responsibility without control
Gram Sabha record is poor or manipulated	participation becomes formal compliance
land/FRA records are incomplete	rights cannot survive project appraisal

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ACCOUNTABILITY ARCHITECTURE

START / CONCEPT: ACCOUNTABILITY ARCHITECTURE

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · accountability · architecture

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for accountability architecture.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of accountability architecture.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise accountability architecture beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Accountability Architecture is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing accountability architecture.

SESSION 49 - CURRENT IMPLEMENTATION CONTROL: PESA RULES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Current Implementation Control: PESA Rules explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current implementation control: pesa rules.

Technical definition: Current Implementation Control: PESA Rules operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current implementation control: pesa rules, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Current Implementation Control: PESA Rules is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current implementation control: pesa rules.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- PESA
- Gram Sabha
- Scheduled Areas
- implementation
- control
- rules

How to use them: Frame the answer through PESA; define Gram Sabha, connect Scheduled Areas with implementation to explain the mechanism, and use control for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 58 - Official rule-status snapshot, 19 Aug 2026

Official MoPR listing includes	Current qualification
Andhra Pradesh 2011	implementation quality must be separately assessed
Telangana adoption in 2014	State adaptation and practice matter
Himachal Pradesh 2011	rules do not prove devolution
Rajasthan Act 1999 / Rules 2011	verify current amendments for granular claims
Maharashtra 2014	sectoral-law conformity remains relevant
Gujarat 2017 and amendment	compliance is multi-law
Chhattisgarh 2022	recent rule does not erase capacity gaps
Madhya Pradesh 2022	same qualification
Jharkhand Rules 2025	official listing uploaded/updated in 2026
Odisha	no separate notified Rules instrument appears in the official central listing

- [CURRENT] The safe summary is **nine listed rule regimes for ten PESA States**, with Odisha the listed gap.
- [LIMIT] Do not equate "rules notified" with "PESA fully implemented"; conformity of excise, markets, money-lending, land, minor minerals, forest produce and Panchayat laws must also be tested.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CURRENT IMPLEMENTATION CONTROL: PESA RULES

START / CONCEPT: CURRENT IMPLEMENTATION CONTROL: PESA RULES

|

v

EXACT TERMS: PESA · Gram Sabha · Scheduled Areas · implementation · control · rules

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for current implementation control: pesa rules.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of current implementation control: pesa rules.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise current implementation control: pesa rules beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Current Implementation Control: PESA Rules is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing current implementation control: pesa rules.

SESSION 50 - CAPACITY, CONVERGENCE AND INSTITUTIONAL REFORM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Capacity, Convergence And Institutional Reform explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing capacity, convergence and institutional reform.

Technical definition: Capacity, Convergence And Institutional Reform operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing capacity, convergence and institutional reform, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Capacity, Convergence And Institutional Reform is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing capacity, convergence and institutional reform.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Article 244**
- **Scheduled Areas**
- **tribal governance**
- **capacity**
- **convergence**
- **institutional**
- **reform**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with capacity to explain the mechanism, and use convergence for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 59 - From legal power to usable power

Gap	Reform design	Evidence discipline
inaccessible law	local-language power cards and habitation maps	name PESA sections
weak meetings	notice, quorum, women/PVTG access and independent facilitation	do not count attendance as voice
poor records	geo-referenced land/CFR maps and public minutes	protect privacy and customary knowledge
fragmented departments	convergence protocol across Tribal, Panchayat, Forest, Revenue and Mining departments	convergence cannot override rights
TAC dormancy	mandatory calendar, public agenda and reasoned response	preserve advisory status
council assent delay	transparent timelines and reasons	retain constitutional checks
displaced responsibility	activity/staff/fund mapping	autonomy requires implementable functions
weak remedy	accessible appeal, legal aid and restoration tracking	remedy must follow violation

Visual 60 - ITDA / programme control

constitutional institution? NO
administrative implementation vehicle? OFTEN, STATE-SPECIFIC
can it replace TAC / Gram Sabha / ADC? NO
can convergence programme waive PESA/FRA? NO

- [ANALYSIS] Integrated Tribal Development Agencies/Projects and current convergence programmes may coordinate delivery, but their mandate and territorial form are administrative and State-specific.
- [LIMIT] Do not quote an ITDA count, dashboard total or programme reach without a dated official source.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CAPACITY, CONVERGENCE AND INSTITUTIONAL REFORM

START / CONCEPT: CAPACITY, CONVERGENCE AND INSTITUTIONAL REFORM

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · capacity · convergence · institutional · reform

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for capacity, convergence and institutional reform.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of capacity, convergence and institutional reform.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise capacity, convergence and institutional reform beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Capacity, Convergence And Institutional Reform is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing capacity, convergence and institutional reform.

SESSION 51 - LADAKH AND EXTENSION DEBATES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Ladakh And Extension Debates explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing ladakh and extension debates.

Technical definition: Ladakh And Extension Debates operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing ladakh and extension debates, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Ladakh And Extension Debates is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing ladakh and extension debates.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Ladakh**
- **Sixth Schedule**
- **autonomy**
- **extension**
- **debates**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Ladakh; define Sixth Schedule, connect autonomy with extension to explain the mechanism, and use debates for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 61 - Extension test

Question	Analytical test
Is tribal population high?	relevant but not sufficient
Are land, culture and employment safeguards needed?	identify concrete risk
Which model fits?	Sixth Schedule, Article 371-type protection, stronger hill councils or legislation may differ
What democratic unit?	village, hill council, ADC or legislature
What State/UT relation?	Sixth Schedule text currently names four States
What legal change?	requires enacted constitutional/legal action, not demand alone

- [CURRENT] Ladakh's constitutional-safeguard demand remains under official dialogue; Sixth Schedule status has not been granted.
- [ANALYSIS] The strongest answer compares institutional fit rather than assuming that the Sixth Schedule is the only possible safeguard.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LADAKH AND EXTENSION DEBATES

START / CONCEPT: LADAKH AND EXTENSION DEBATES

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Ladakh · Sixth Schedule · autonomy · extension · debates

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for ladakh and extension debates.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of ladakh and extension debates.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise ladakh and extension debates beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Ladakh And Extension Debates is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing ladakh and extension debates.

SESSION 52 - REFORM PRINCIPLES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Reform Principles explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing reform principles.

Technical definition: Reform Principles operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing reform principles, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Reform Principles is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing reform principles.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- reform
- principles

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with reform to explain the mechanism, and use principles for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 62 - Eight-point reform compass

- 1 territorial accuracy
- 2 subsidiarity
- 3 legally precise participation
- 4 secure land and forest records
- 5 accountable Governor/State/Union action
- 6 council fiscal and staff capacity
- 7 rights-respecting development sequencing
- 8 transparent review with remedies

- [ANALYSIS] Reform should convert protection into agency without romanticising custom or weakening constitutional rights.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - REFORM PRINCIPLES

START / CONCEPT: REFORM PRINCIPLES

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · reform · principles

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for reform principles.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of reform principles.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise reform principles beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Reform Principles is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing reform principles.

SESSION 53 - PRELIMS TRAP BOARD

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Prelims Trap Board explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing prelims trap board.

Technical definition: Prelims Trap Board operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing prelims trap board, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Prelims Trap Board is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing prelims trap board.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244
- Scheduled Areas
- tribal governance
- board

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with board to explain the mechanism, and close with the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 63 - High-frequency reversals

Wrong	Correct
Fifth Schedule applies to Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram	Sixth Schedule applies there
Governor declares Scheduled Areas	President declares by order
Governor declares Scheduled Tribes	President specifies under Article 342; Parliament alters
TAC legislates	TAC advises
State loses executive power in Scheduled Area	State power continues under report/direction supervision
Governor's regulation needs Governor assent	it needs President's assent
ADC has 30 elected members everywhere	ordinary maximum 30 with nominations; special exceptions exist
ADC controls reserved forests	paragraph 3 excludes reserved forests
PESA applies to Sixth Schedule areas	PESA applies to Fifth Schedule Scheduled Areas
PESA means consent for every project	verbs vary by subject and stage
Niyamgiri made Gram Sabha final clearance authority	MoEF retained final Stage-II decision in light of Gram Sabha decisions
Article 371 equals Sixth Schedule	separate constitutional techniques

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PRELIMS TRAP BOARD

START / CONCEPT: PRELIMS TRAP BOARD

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · board

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for prelims trap board.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of prelims trap board.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise prelims trap board beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Prelims Trap Board is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing prelims trap board.

SESSION 54 - MAINS ANSWER-WRITING METHOD

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mains Answer-Writing Method explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing mains answer-writing method.

Technical definition: Mains Answer-Writing Method operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing mains answer-writing method, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mains Answer-Writing Method is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing mains answer-writing method.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 244

- **Scheduled Areas**
- **tribal governance**
- **writing**
- **method**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with writing to explain the mechanism, and use method for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 64 - Evidence-led paragraph

CLAIM

- > NAMED CONSTITUTIONAL / STATUTORY / JUDICIAL EVIDENCE
- > WHAT THE MECHANISM DOES
- > WHY IT MATTERS
- > IMPLEMENTATION OR DOCTRINAL QUALIFICATION
- > MINI-VERDICT

Example

- **Claim:** PESA is stronger than generic consultation.
- **Evidence:** section 4(e) requires Gram Sabha approval of local plans; section 4(i) uses consultation for acquisition/R&R; sections 4(k)-(l) make recommendations mandatory for specified minor-mineral decisions.
- **Analysis:** Parliament calibrated community power to the decision type.
- **Qualification:** it did not enact one universal veto.
- **Mini-verdict:** legal precision strengthens, rather than weakens, the case for meaningful participation.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - MAINS ANSWER-WRITING METHOD

START / CONCEPT: MAINS ANSWER-WRITING METHOD

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · writing · method

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for mains answer-writing method.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of mains answer-writing method.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise mains answer-writing method beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Mains Answer-Writing Method is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing mains answer-writing method.

SESSION 55 - THESIS SELECTOR

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Thesis Selector explains the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing thesis selector.

Technical definition: Thesis Selector operates through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing thesis selector, with authority, procedure, limits and dated status kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Thesis Selector is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing thesis selector.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Article 244**
- **Scheduled Areas**
- **tribal governance**
- **thesis**
- **selector**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 244; define Scheduled Areas, connect tribal governance with thesis to explain the mechanism, and use selector for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 65 - Demand-to-thesis matrix

Demand	Defensible thesis
rationale	differentiated administration is justified by substantive equality, but must convert protection into agency
Fifth Schedule	strong supervisory powers are weakened by opaque reporting, TAC agenda control and implementation dormancy
Sixth Schedule	councils create real legislative-executive-fiscal autonomy, yet remain subject-specific and State-supervised
comparison	Fifth is guardian-centred protection; Sixth is council-centred self-government
PESA	section 4 is a calibrated power code, not a universal veto
FRA link	tenure recognition and community forest governance make participation materially meaningful
mining conflict	lawful development requires cumulative compliance, not substitution of one clearance for another
reform	transparency, records, capacity and remedy must connect constitutional text to community power

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THESIS SELECTOR

START / CONCEPT: THESIS SELECTOR

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 244 · Scheduled Areas · tribal governance · thesis · selector

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Trace the governing provision, empowered institution, procedure and legal check for thesis selector.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This determines the rights, autonomy, accountability and exam consequence of thesis selector.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not generalise thesis selector beyond its exact territorial field, legal verb, assent rule or dated status.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Thesis Selector is best understood through the exact constitutional, statutory and institutional rules governing thesis selector.

POLITY HOSTILE SEMANTIC-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Keep Article 244, Article 244A, the Fifth Schedule and the Sixth Schedule separate before adding the statutory PESA and FRA layers.
- **Close distinction:** PESA section 4 uses distinct verbs: approval, consultation, mandatory prior recommendation, ownership and control. None creates one universal veto.
- **Legal/source limit:** The 4 August 2026 MHA parliamentary answer identifies ten Sixth-Schedule ADCs in four States; Ladakh remains outside the Sixth Schedule.

Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

- **Constitutional map:** Article 244(1) applies the Fifth Schedule to Scheduled

Areas and Scheduled Tribes in States other than Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram; Article 244(2) applies the Sixth Schedule to tribal areas in those four States. Article 244A is a separate parliamentary route for an autonomous State within Assam.

- **Fifth-Schedule territory:** the President declares, enlarges, diminishes, alters or rescinds a Scheduled Area by order after the constitutional consultation route. Official Ministry of Tribal Affairs material continues to list Scheduled Areas in ten States.

- **Fifth-Schedule administration:** State executive power extends to Scheduled Areas; the Governor reports annually, or whenever required, to the President; and Union executive power extends to directions regarding administration.

- **TAC precision:** a Tribes Advisory Council has not more than twenty members. As nearly as may be, three-fourths are representatives of Scheduled Tribes in the State Legislative Assembly, with the Schedule's shortfall rule. It advises on welfare and advancement matters referred by the Governor; it does not legislate.

- **Governor's paragraph 5 power:** by public notification the Governor may direct that an Act does not apply, or applies with exceptions/modifications, and may make peace-and-good-government regulations on tribal land transfer, land allotment and money-lending. Regulations require presidential assent and, where a TAC exists, consultation with it.

- **Sixth-Schedule institutions:** the Governor organises autonomous districts and regions. District and Regional Councils exercise textually specified legislative, judicial, executive and revenue powers; council laws requiring assent, State-law application and parliamentary-law application remain paragraph- and State-specific rather than one blanket rule.

- **Current council map:** an official MHA Lok Sabha answer dated 4 August 2026 lists ten Sixth-Schedule Autonomous District Councils: three in Assam, three in Meghalaya, three in Mizoram and one in Tripura. Special council designs, including Bodoland, must not be replaced by the ordinary maximum-thirty model.

- **PESA verbs:** section 4 of the PESA Act, 1996 distinguishes Gram Sabha approval of plans/programmes/projects, beneficiary identification, utilisation certification, consultation before land acquisition and rehabilitation, and mandatory prior recommendation for specified minor-mineral licences, leases and concessions. Ownership of minor forest produce and specified control powers do not create a universal project veto.

- **FRA and judgments:** the Forest Rights Act, 2006 has its own rights-recognition process initiated through the Gram Sabha. Samatha (1997) is used within its Andhra Pradesh Scheduled-Area land-transfer setting. Orissa Mining Corporation (2013) required Gram Sabha determination of specified FRA-linked cultural and religious claims at Niyamgiri while leaving the final Stage-II decision with MoEF.

- **Ownership/PYQ firewall:** Topic 23 owns Panchayat structure and the PESA local-government bridge; Topic 22 owns Articles 371-371J; Topic 31 owns the National Commissions; Topic 53 owns the wider special-provisions-for-classes architecture. Direct and routed 2019-2026 Scheduled-Area demands retain their official-key or answer-free status without fabricated answer letters.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Original MCQ loop - strict continuous A -> B -> C -> D rotation

OM1. Article 244 mapping

Which pairing is correct?

A. Article 244(1)-Fifth Schedule; Article 244(2)-Sixth Schedule. B. Article 339-Sixth Schedule council composition. C. Article 244(1)-Sixth Schedule; Article 244(2)-Fifth Schedule. D. Article 244A-Fifth Schedule declaration by President.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 244 is the gateway that applies the two Schedules to their different territorial fields.

OM2. Fifth Schedule States

Which statement is correct as on 5 September 2026?

A. Assam is one of the 10 Fifth Schedule States. B. Official Central material identifies notified Fifth Schedule areas in 10 States. C. Every State with an ST population has a notified Scheduled Area. D. All territory in those 10 States is scheduled.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [CURRENT] Ten States have notified areas; notification is territorial, not State-wide.

OM3. Declaration authority

A legally effective Scheduled Area status is created by:

A. a Gram Sabha resolution under PESA. B. a State Cabinet decision. C. a Presidential Order under the Fifth Schedule. D. a TAC resolution.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Administrative criteria guide identification, but the Presidential Order creates status.

OM4. Executive power

Which is the most accurate consequence of Fifth Schedule notification?

A. The State loses all executive power. B. The area becomes a Union Territory. C. An ADC assumes total administration. D. State executive power continues, subject to Governor reporting and Union directions.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Paragraph 3 creates supervision, not automatic substitution of government.

OM5. TAC composition

Which statement reflects the Fifth Schedule?

A. TAC has not more than 20 members, with the specified ST-legislator representation rule. B. TAC is chaired constitutionally by the President. C. TAC exists only in Sixth Schedule States. D. TAC has 30 elected members and four nominees.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] The 30-member pattern belongs to the ordinary Sixth Schedule council ceiling.

OM6. TAC function

The primary constitutional duty of the TAC is to:

A. decide forest-right claims. B. advise on ST welfare and advancement matters referred by the Governor. C. assent to State legislation. D. levy land revenue.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] TAC advice is not legislation, adjudication or executive approval.

OM7. Fifth Schedule regulations

A Governor-made regulation under paragraph 5 takes effect after:

A. State Assembly ratification. B. Supreme Court certification. C. presidential assent. D. TAC approval alone.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] TAC consultation where it exists precedes the regulation; presidential assent gives effect.

OM8. Law-application direction

Which power can expressly operate retrospectively?

A. Article 342 ST notification only. B. TAC advice. C. Gram Sabha beneficiary selection. D. Governor's direction adapting/non-applying a law in a Scheduled Area.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Fifth Schedule paragraph 5(1) permits retrospective effect.

OM9. Article 339

Article 339(2) principally concerns:

A. Union directions on State schemes essential for ST welfare. B. recognition of ST communities. C. Governor assent to ADC laws. D. creation of an autonomous State within Assam.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] It is a welfare-scheme direction power, distinct from Article 244A.

OM10. Article 275(1)

Which provision supports grants for ST welfare and raising Scheduled-Area administration?

A. Article 243D. B. Article 275(1). C. Article 300A. D. Article 371A.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 275(1) is the constitutional fiscal route.

OM11. Fifth Schedule evaluation

Which conclusion is best?

A. Union directions remove the need for State administration. B. Constitutional powers guarantee outcomes without institutions. C. effectiveness depends on timely power use, participation, records and capacity. D. TAC is stronger than a legislature.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] The framework's performance is multiplicative, not self-executing.

OM12. Territorial trap

Which statement is false?

A. Some districts may be only partly covered. B. Presidential Orders define Scheduled Area coverage. C. ST population alone does not create status. D. Once a State is listed, its entire territory is a Scheduled Area.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Legal status attaches only to notified territory.

OM13. Sixth Schedule States

Which is the complete Sixth Schedule set?

A. Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. B. Assam, Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram. C. Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh. D. All eight North-Eastern States.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] "A-M-T-M" is the exact constitutional set.

OM14. Autonomous regions

An autonomous region may be created where:

A. Parliament declares a new State. B. different Scheduled Tribes inhabit parts of an autonomous district. C. a TAC demands taxation power. D. a Scheduled Area becomes a UT.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] The Governor may divide such areas into autonomous regions.

OM15. Ordinary council composition

Which statement is correct?

A. Every District Council has exactly 30 elected members. B. Elected members have no fixed term. C. The ordinary ceiling is 30, with not more than four Governor-nominated members. D. All members are nominated by the Governor.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Special amendments, including BTC's design, create exceptions.

OM16. Council law

A District/Regional Council law under paragraph 3 ordinarily takes effect after:

A. President's assent. B. TAC consultation. C. State Cabinet approval alone. D. Governor's assent.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] This is the crucial Fifth-versus-Sixth assent reversal.

OM17. Council legislative field

Which is a paragraph 3 subject?

A. regulation of shifting cultivation. B. citizenship. C. defence. D. currency.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Land, non-reserved forests, local institutions and customary matters are core fields.

OM18. Forest competence

Which forest category is excluded from the ordinary paragraph 3 forest field?

A. community forest resource. B. reserved forest. C. protected forest. D. village forest.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] The omission of "reserved" is a standard close-option discriminator.

OM19. Council courts

The safest description of Sixth Schedule judicial power is:

A. judicial power exists only under PESA. B. ADCs try every criminal offence. C. village/council courts handle specified matters within the tribal-party jurisdictional boundary. D. ADCs replace all High Courts.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Jurisdiction is bounded by parties, territory, subject and rules.

OM20. Fiscal autonomy

Which is within the Sixth Schedule revenue basket?

A. corporation tax. B. customs duty. C. GST on inter-State supply. D. specified taxes on professions, animals/vehicles, markets and local services.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] Council fiscal power is constitutionally specified, not plenary.

OM21. Mineral royalties

Paragraph 9 contemplates:

A. an agreed share of mineral royalties for the District Council. B. automatic cancellation of every State lease. C. exclusive council ownership of all minerals. D. no State role in minerals.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Revenue sharing is not mineral sovereignty.

OM22. Bodoland exception

Which statement is accurate?

A. BTC follows an invariable 26 elected plus four nominated design. B. BTC has a special 46-member design: 40 elected and six nominated. C. BTC is a Fifth Schedule TAC. D. BTC is an autonomous State under Article 244A.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] The exception warns against universalising the ordinary paragraph 2 model.

OM23. Assam asymmetry

Paragraphs 3A and 3B illustrate:

A. abolition of Governor assent. B. extension of PESA to BTC. C. additional subject allocations for specified Assam councils. D. automatic Statehood.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Sixth Schedule autonomy is internally asymmetric.

OM24. Article 244A

Article 244A enables Parliament to:

A. notify an ST list. B. create a PESA State. C. declare all Assam a Scheduled Area. D. create an autonomous State within Assam with a legislature/CoM.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] It is deeper than an ADC but remains an enabling constitutional route.

OM25. PESA reach

PESA applies to:

A. Fifth Schedule Scheduled Areas. B. all Sixth Schedule tribal areas. C. every rural area in India. D. only forest land.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 243M exclusion is modified by PESA for Fifth Schedule areas.

OM26. Acquisition and R&R

PESA section 4 requires, before land acquisition and resettlement/rehabilitation:

A. universal Gram Sabha consent. B. consultation with the Gram Sabha or Panchayat at the appropriate level. C. President's assent. D. TAC legislation.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Consultation must not be inflated into the different verb "consent".

OM27. Minor minerals

Which PESA formulation is correct?

A. every major-mineral project needs TAC approval. B. every mine needs President's assent. C. specified minor-mineral licences/leases require mandatory prior recommendation. D. Gram Sabha owns all subsoil minerals.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Section 4(k)-(l) uses recommendation for specified minor-mineral decisions.

OM28. Section 4(m)

Which basket best reflects PESA?

A. High Court appointments and police command. B. defence, foreign affairs and currency. C. Statehood, citizenship and emergency. D. minor forest produce, markets, money-lending, intoxicants and land-restoration powers.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] State law must specifically endow the Gram Sabha/Panchayats at the appropriate level.

OM29. FRA claims

The statutory claims process begins with:

A. the Gram Sabha. B. the District Council. C. the Governor. D. the President.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] FRA section 6 makes the Gram Sabha the initiating authority.

OM30. CFR right

Community Forest Resource rights include the right to:

A. abolish reserved forests. B. protect, regenerate, conserve or manage the community forest resource. C. bypass the FRA committee process. D. own every mineral.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] CFR is a management/conservation right distinct from an individual cultivation right.

OM31. Niyamgiri holding

Which statement is most accurate?

- A. The Court granted every Gram Sabha a nationwide mining veto. B. The Court transferred mineral ownership to the Dongria Kondh. C. Gram Sabhas determined FRA-linked claims; MoEF retained final Stage-II decision in light of them. D. The case concerned only ordinary EIA public hearings.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] This preserves both community-right determination and statutory clearance authority.

OM32. Samatha (1997) limit

The safest use of *Samatha (1997)* is:

- A. all private mining in India is void. B. Fifth Schedule itself nationalised minerals. C. the ruling has no tribal-land relevance. D. cite its Andhra Pradesh regulation-based holding and expressly qualify nationwide extension.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [LIMIT] Legal setting and later scope treatment are indispensable.

OM33. Article 371 distinction

Which statement is correct?

- A. Article 371 provisions are distinct State-specific arrangements, not synonyms for the Sixth Schedule. B. Article 371 automatically creates ADCs. C. Article 371 eliminates Part III. D. Article 371 applies PESA to Mizoram.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Examples include Article 371A and 371G, each with its own text.

OM34. Ordinary Panchayats

Article 243M means that:

- A. ADCs are ordinary Zila Parishads. B. Scheduled Areas and tribal areas are excluded from automatic Part IX application, with PESA extending it to Fifth Schedule areas. C. Part IX automatically applies unchanged to every Scheduled/tribal area. D. Panchayats can never exist in the North-East.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] PESA is the Fifth Schedule modification route.

OM35. Current PESA rule status

Which dated statement is supported by the official MoPR listing on 5 September 2026?

- A. Odisha is the only State with rules. B. All ten States have identical rules. C. Nine State rule regimes are listed, including Jharkhand 2025; Odisha is not separately listed. D. PESA has been repealed.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [CURRENT] Notification status is not implementation completeness.

OM36. Reform principle

Which reform best respects the constitutional design?

- A. let convergence programmes waive PESA/FRA. B. replace Gram Sabhas with dashboards. C. treat TAC advice as a statute. D. combine transparent reporting, land/CFR records, council capacity, precise participation and accessible remedies.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] Reform must connect legal authority to usable, reviewable community power.

Remedial MCQs - strict continuation A -> C -> A -> D rotation

RM1. President-Governor reversal

Which matching is correct?

A. President-declares Scheduled Area; Governor-organises Sixth Schedule districts/regions. B. Governor-declares Scheduled Area; President-organises ADCs. C. Gram Sabha-declares tribal area; Governor-declares ST list. D. TAC-declares ST list; Parliament-declares Scheduled Area.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Keep area declaration, ST specification and Sixth Schedule organisation on separate tracks.

RM2. Assent reversal

Which pairing is accurate?

A. both-President assent. B. Fifth Schedule regulation-President assent; Sixth Schedule council law-Governor assent. C. neither requires assent. D. Fifth Schedule regulation-Governor assent; Sixth Schedule law-President assent.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] This reversal frequently decides a statement question.

RM3. TAC versus ADC

Which institutional comparison is correct?

A. TAC is more autonomous than an ADC. B. Both levy taxes. C. TAC advises; ADC can legislate, administer, adjudicate specified disputes and levy specified taxes. D. Both are advisory.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] Fifth and Sixth Schedule bodies are not interchangeable.

RM4. State executive power

Scheduling an area under the Fifth Schedule:

A. creates a local sovereign government. B. ends the State's executive power. C. triggers President's Rule. D. retains State administration within the Schedule's reporting and direction structure.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [FACT] This directly remedies the 2025 PYQ trap.

RM5. PESA scope

Which statement is correct?

A. PESA modifies Part IX for Fifth Schedule Scheduled Areas. B. PESA replaces FRA. C. PESA creates Sixth Schedule councils. D. PESA applies only to one State.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] The statutes complement each other but have different objects.

RM6. PESA verb

Before acquisition and R&R in a Scheduled Area, the central PESA text uses:

A. ownership. B. consultation. C. adjudication. D. approval.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Minor-mineral decisions use a different "recommendation" rule.

RM7. Forest rights

Which institution initiates FRA claims?

A. ADC in every State. B. MoEFCC. C. Gram Sabha. D. TAC.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [FACT] The process then moves through Sub-Divisional and District Level Committees.

RM8. Niyamgiri limit

Which statement must be rejected?

A. FRA-linked religious claims were considered. B. MoEF retained the final Stage-II decision. C. Gram Sabha decisions informed the clearance process. D. The judgment created an unlimited Gram Sabha veto over every Indian project.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [LIMIT] The holding was project-, statute- and claim-specific.

RM9. Council forest power

Which is correct?

A. Paragraph 3 includes management of forests other than reserved forests. B. FRA is inapplicable in the North-East. C. Council law requires President's assent. D. ADCs control every national park automatically.

Answer: A.

Explanation: [FACT] Reserved-forest exclusion and Governor assent are the key qualifiers.

RM10. Article 244A

Article 244A is specifically associated with:

A. declaration of Scheduled Tribes. B. an autonomous-State route within Assam. C. PESA rules in Odisha. D. Fifth Schedule regulations nationwide.

Answer: B.

Explanation: [FACT] It should not be confused with an existing ADC.

RM11. Current law control

Which is the safest dated statement?

A. Every PESA State has fully implemented every section. B. Odisha has a separately listed official rule instrument. C. The MoPR listing shows nine rule regimes and the implementation gap remains a separate question. D. Jharkhand has no PESA rules.

Answer: C.

Explanation: [CURRENT] Jharkhand Rules 2025 appear in the official list; Odisha does not.

RM12. Answer-writing sequence

The strongest mining-rights paragraph is:

A. slogan -> unsourced statistic -> conclusion. B. case name -> universal claim. C. Article list without facts. D. claim -> Fifth/PESA/FRA/State-law evidence -> project mechanism -> analysis -> case-specific qualification.

Answer: D.

Explanation: [ANALYSIS] This sequence preserves legal accuracy and examiner-visible reasoning.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified routed Prelims PYQs

PYQ 1 - UPSC Prelims 2019, Q50

Verified from the locally held official paper:

Under which Schedule of the Constitution of India can the transfer of tribal land to private parties for mining be declared null and void? A. Third Schedule B. Fifth Schedule C. Ninth Schedule D. Twelfth Schedule

Key status: The audited local ledger records that an official key is unavailable locally. No answer letter is presented as official.

Tested concept: [FACT] Fifth Schedule paragraph 5 permits gubernatorial regulations restricting tribal land transfers in Scheduled Areas, subject to TAC consultation where one exists and presidential assent. [FACT] *Samatha (1997)* applied the Andhra Pradesh Scheduled Areas Land Transfer Regulation to invalidate the impugned mining leases in its specific legal setting.

Qualification: [LIMIT] The legal result depends on the applicable Fifth Schedule regulation/State law and facts; the case is not a free-standing nationwide ban detached from those instruments.

PYQ 2 - UPSC Prelims 2022, Q73

Verified routed demand: consequences of bringing an area under the Fifth Schedule.

Wording control: The routing ledger preserves the neutral demand but the exact official-paper wording and official key are not available in the verified local corpus used for this export. They are not reconstructed.

Concept model

Consequence	Governing rule
legal status	President declares a Scheduled Area
ordinary administration	State executive power continues
supervision	Governor reports; Union may give directions
advisory institution	TAC in the State
protective adaptation	Governor may adapt laws and make land/money-lending regulations
self-government layer	PESA applies through State law

Key status: No option is inferred. The concept lesson is that scheduling produces protective administration; it does not create a UT, a Sixth Schedule ADC or automatic Union administration.

PYQ 3 - UPSC Prelims 2023, Q39

Verified from the locally held official paper:

With reference to "Scheduled Areas" in India, consider the following statements: 1. Within a State, the notification of an area as Scheduled Area takes place through an Order of the President. 2. The largest administrative unit forming the Scheduled Area is the District and the lowest is the cluster of villages in the Block. 3. The Chief Ministers of the concerned States are required to submit annual reports to the Union Home Ministry on the administration of Scheduled Areas in the States. How many of the above statements are correct? A. Only one B. Only two C. All three D. None

Key status: The official key is unavailable in the audited local corpus; no option is inferred.

Statement audit without key inference

- [FACT] Statement 1 tracks Fifth Schedule paragraph 6: Scheduled Area status is created through a Presidential Order.

- [FACT] The Ministry's official administrative criteria speak of a viable unit such as a district, block or taluk and compact territory. [LIMIT] Because the official key is unavailable, this package does not convert that guidance into a declared answer on statement 2.
- [FACT] Paragraph 3 assigns the annual/required report to the **Governor** and the recipient is the **President**, not the Chief Minister and Union Home Ministry as stated.

PYQ 4 - UPSC Prelims 2024, Q84

Verified from the locally held official paper:

Consider the following statements: 1. It is the Governor of the State who recognizes and declares any community of that State as a Scheduled Tribe. 2. A community declared as a Scheduled Tribe in a State need not be so in another State. Which of the statements given above is/are correct? A. 1 only B. 2 only C. Both 1 and 2 D. Neither 1 nor 2

Official Set-A key: B.

Explanation: [FACT] Article 342 authorises the President to specify STs for a State/UT by public notification, after the constitutionally required consultation, and Parliament may later include/exclude by law. [FACT] ST status is State/UT-specific, so the same community need not have the same status everywhere.

PYQ 5 - UPSC Prelims 2025, Q56

Verified from the locally held official paper:

With reference to the Constitution of India, if an area in a State is declared as Scheduled Area under the Fifth Schedule: I. the State Government loses its executive power in such areas and a local body assumes total administration; II. the Union Government can take over the total administration of such areas under certain circumstances on the recommendations of the Governor. Which of the statements given above is/are correct? A. I only B. II only C. Both I and II D. Neither I nor II

Official Set-A key: D.

Explanation: [FACT] State executive power continues. [FACT] The Governor reports to the President and Union executive power extends to directions on administration. [LIMIT] Neither proposition in the stem accurately describes a local-body or Union "total administration" takeover.

PYQ 6 - UPSC Prelims 2026, Q57

Verified from the locally held official paper:

Consider the following statements about the provisions pertaining to the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes in India: 1. Provisions regarding the administration of the Tribal Areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram are given in the Fifth Schedule. 2. Some tribes of India are entitled to exemption from paying Income Tax on certain incomes. 3. The Constitution provides for reservation of seats in Panchayats for women belonging to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. Which conclusion based on the statements is correct? A. There are two correct statements, including statement 2. B. There are two correct statements, statements 1 and 3. C. There is only one correct statement. D. All three statements are correct.

Key status: A provisional Set-A key is held locally, but the routing ledger deliberately records no answer letter and no answer is inferred here.

Concept audit

- [FACT] Statement 1 reverses the Schedules: the four named States are the Sixth Schedule field.
- [FACT] Income-tax Act section 10(26) contains a conditional statutory exemption for specified income of eligible ST members residing in specified areas; it is not a blanket tribal exemption.
- [FACT] Article 243D includes SC/ST reservation in Panchayats and requires not less than one-third of reserved SC/ST seats to be reserved for women belonging to those categories.
- [LIMIT] Because the locally held key is provisional and no letter is recorded in the ledger, this package does not declare an answer option.

PYQ coverage control

- [FACT] The audited 2018-2026 routing ledgers identify six direct objective demands for this owner.
- [LIMIT] Exact wording is reproduced only where verified against a locally held official paper. Official answer letters are stated only for the locally held final 2024 and 2025 Set-A keys.

Original solved Mains practice

M1. Explain the constitutional rationale for separate administration of Scheduled and tribal areas. (10 marks, 150 words)

Model solution

Thesis: [ANALYSIS] The Fifth and Sixth Schedules use differentiated governance to achieve substantive equality where historical alienation, customary institutions, geographic isolation and land-resource dependence make ordinary administration inadequate.

Historical basis: [FACT] Colonial excluded-area administration concentrated executive control. Constituent Assembly subcommittees led by A.V. Thakkar and Gopinath Bordoloi redesigned differentiation around protection and self-government. [ANALYSIS] The Constitution therefore retained special territory while changing its democratic purpose.

Two models: [FACT] Article 244(1) applies the Fifth Schedule: Presidential declaration, Governor reporting/regulations, Union directions and TAC advice. Article 244(2) applies the Sixth: elected councils with specified legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers. [ANALYSIS] The first is guardian-centred protection; the second is territorial autonomy.

Rights layer: [FACT] PESA 1996 and FRA 2006 add Gram Sabha participation and forest-right recognition. [ANALYSIS] They convert communities from administrative objects into rights-bearing participants.

Qualification: [LIMIT] Special administration can become paternalistic or opaque; custom also remains subject to Fundamental Rights.

Verdict: Differentiation is legitimate when it secures land, culture, voice and accountable self-rule, not when it creates permanent executive tutelage.

Why this earns marks: It answers "why", names the constitutional models, supplies history and statutes, and ends with a qualified normative test.

How to improve / compress: Compress the historical opening to two lines, then organise the body as Fifth Schedule protection versus Sixth Schedule self-government; reserve PESA/FRA for the final analytical paragraph.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "M1. Explain the constitutional rationale for separate administration of Scheduled and tribal...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M1. Explain the constitutional rationale for separate administration of Scheduled and tribal areas. (10 marks, 150 words)".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** M1. Explain the constitutional rationale for separate administration of Scheduled and tribal areas. (10 marks, 150 words) **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Rights layer: [FACT] PESA 1996 and FRA 2006 add Gram Sabha participation and forest-right recognition. [ANALYSIS] They convert communities from administrative objects into rights-bearing participants. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Qualification: [LIMIT] Special administration can become paternalistic or opaque; custom also remains subject to Fundamental Rights. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Verdict: Differentiation is legitimate when it secures land, culture, voice and accountable self-rule, not when it creates permanent executive tutelage. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It answers "why", names the constitutional models, supplies history and statutes, and ends with a qualified normative test. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M1. Explain the constitutional rationale for separate administration of Scheduled and tribal areas. (10 marks, 150 words)".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "M1. Explain the constitutional rationale for separate administration of Scheduled and tribal...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

M2. "The Fifth Schedule is constitutionally powerful but institutionally under-activated." Examine. (10 marks, 150 words)

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] The Fifth Schedule supplies strong supervisory and protective tools; [ANALYSIS] their impact depends on transparent use by the Governor, State and Union and meaningful community participation.

Power: The President declares/changes Scheduled Areas. The Governor reports annually, may adapt parliamentary/State laws and make peace-and-good-government regulations on land transfer, allotment and money-lending, subject to TAC consultation and presidential assent. Union directions and Articles 275(1)/339 add fiscal and welfare supervision.

Under-activation: [ANALYSIS] TAC agenda depends on gubernatorial reference; reports lack a constitutionally mandated public template; protective regulations and PESA conformity may lag; State revenue/mining priorities can conflict with anti-alienation goals.

Named evidence: [FACT] PESA section 4 creates precise Gram Sabha/Panchayat powers, while the official 2026 rule listing still shows Odisha without a separately listed rules instrument. [ANALYSIS] Enactment has not ensured uniform implementation.

Qualification: [LIMIT] The Governor's powers should not be misstated as unreviewable personal discretion.

Verdict: Activation requires public reporting, reasoned TAC follow-up, cross-law conformity, records and enforceable remedies.

Why this earns marks: It balances text and performance, uses exact institutions and a dated official implementation control.

How to improve / compress: Add one paragraph separating constitutional design from implementation: Governor report/TAC/paragraph 5 powers on one side and dated PESA-rule compliance on the other.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "M2. "The Fifth Schedule is constitutionally powerful but institutionally under-activated."...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M2. "The Fifth Schedule is constitutionally powerful but institutionally under-activated." Examine. (10 marks, 150 words)".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** M2. "The Fifth Schedule is constitutionally powerful but institutionally under-activated." Examine. (10 marks, 150 words) **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Thesis: [FACT] The Fifth Schedule supplies strong supervisory and protective tools; [ANALYSIS] their impact depends on transparent use by the Governor, State and Union and meaningful community participation. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Qualification: [LIMIT] The Governor's powers should not be misstated as unreviewable personal discretion. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Verdict: Activation requires public reporting, reasoned TAC follow-up, cross-law conformity, records and enforceable remedies. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Why this earns marks: It balances text and performance, uses exact institutions and a dated official implementation control. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M2. "The Fifth Schedule is constitutionally powerful but institutionally under-activated." Examine. (10 marks, 150 words)".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "M2. "The Fifth Schedule is constitutionally powerful but institutionally under-activated."...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

M3. Discuss the legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers of Sixth Schedule councils and their constitutional limits. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] Sixth Schedule councils are constitutionally protected territorial governments with multi-functional autonomy; [ANALYSIS] they remain subject-specific bodies within State and Union constitutional authority, not sovereign legislatures.

Legislative: Paragraph 3 covers land use, non-reserved forests, agricultural water, shifting cultivation, village administration, chiefs/headmen, inheritance, marriage/divorce and social customs. Laws require Governor assent. Assam paragraphs 3A/3B enlarge powers for specified councils.

Executive: Paragraph 6 permits management of primary schools, dispensaries, markets, ferries, fisheries, roads and entrusted welfare/planning functions. [ANALYSIS] Functional autonomy is strongest where staff and funds follow the subject.

Judicial: Paragraph 4 allows village/council courts and appeals for specified disputes involving tribal parties. [LIMIT] High Courts and the ordinary justice system retain their constitutional place.

Fiscal: Councils assess land revenue, levy specified taxes and maintain District/Regional Funds; paragraph 9 provides a mineral-royalty share. Article 275(1) supports capacity. [LIMIT] Revenue sharing is neither mineral ownership nor fiscal sovereignty.

Checks: Governor assent/approval, inquiry, suspension and specified dissolution/supersession powers; State-specific paragraphs govern application of laws; Parliament may amend the Schedule.

Named examples: [CURRENT] Assam's BTC has a special 46-member design; Meghalaya's three ADCs route instruments through State scrutiny to the Governor.

Verdict: The Schedule creates meaningful autonomy when constitutional powers, administrative transfer and democratic accountability operate together.

Why this earns marks: It organises the answer by four power types, names paragraphs/examples and repeatedly identifies the limits.

How to improve / compress: Use four labelled heads-legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal-and attach one textual limit to each; omit minor examples if writing a 10-marker.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "M3. Discuss the legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers of Sixth Schedule councils...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M3. Discuss the legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers of Sixth Schedule councils and their constitutional limits. (15 marks, 250 words)".

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** M3. Discuss the legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers of Sixth Schedule councils and their constitutional limits. (15 marks, 250 words) **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** Judicial: Paragraph 4 allows village/council courts and appeals for specified disputes involving tribal parties. [LIMIT] High Courts and the ordinary justice system retain their constitutional place. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** Checks: Governor assent/approval, inquiry, suspension and specified dissolution/supersession powers; State-specific paragraphs govern application of laws; Parliament may amend the

Schedule. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Named examples: [CURRENT] Assam's BTC has a special 46-member design; Meghalaya's three ADCs route instruments through State scrutiny to the Governor. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Verdict: The Schedule creates meaningful autonomy when constitutional powers, administrative transfer and democratic accountability operate together. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M3. Discuss the legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers of Sixth Schedule councils and their constitutional limits. (15 marks, 250 words)".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "M3. Discuss the legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers of Sixth Schedule councils...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

M4. Compare the Fifth and Sixth Schedules as competing models of tribal governance. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model solution

Thesis: [ANALYSIS] The Schedules answer the same problem through different institutional theories: the Fifth relies on protective supervision; the Sixth constitutionalises elected territorial self-government.

Dimension	Fifth	Sixth
territory	Presidential Scheduled Area Orders in 10 States	tribal areas in four North-Eastern States
institution	advisory TAC	elected District/Regional Councils
law	Governor adapts laws/makes regulations; President assents	council laws on specified subjects; Governor assents
administration	State continues under reporting/Union directions	councils manage specified services within State authority
justice/finance	no Schedule-created TAC courts/taxes	specified courts, land revenue and taxes
local participation	PESA extends modified Part IX	PESA does not apply

Analysis: [FACT] The Fifth's land-transfer and money-lending regulation powers can be strong, and PESA/FRA deepen community agency. Yet TAC advice and gubernatorial initiative may remain dormant. The Sixth's elected councils provide continuous local law-making and finance, but assent delays, limited subjects, State control and intra-area representation disputes constrain autonomy.

Named evidence: *Samatha (1997)* illustrates protective land law in the Fifth context; BTC's special design shows adaptable Sixth Schedule autonomy.

Qualification: [LIMIT] "Sixth is always better" ignores context, council accountability and non-Sixth alternatives such as Article 371 or strengthened hill councils.

Verdict: The best reform imports the Sixth's agency into Fifth Schedule practice without treating either model as institutionally complete.

Why this earns marks: It compares on identical axes, uses evidence and avoids a simplistic hierarchy.

How to improve / compress: Build the comparison on identical axes (territory, body, powers, assent, finance and accountability), then give a qualified verdict rather than calling one model universally superior.

Demand decoding: The directive **compare** requires a direct position on "M4. Compare the Fifth and Sixth Schedules as competing models of tribal governance. (15...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M4. Compare the Fifth and Sixth Schedules as competing models of tribal governance. (15 marks, 250 words)".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** M4. Compare the Fifth and Sixth Schedules as competing models of tribal governance. (15 marks, 250 words) **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Thesis: [ANALYSIS] The Schedules answer the same problem through different institutional theories: the Fifth relies on protective supervision; the Sixth constitutionalises elected territorial self-government. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** territory Presidential Scheduled Area Orders in 10 States tribal areas in four North-Eastern States **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** institution advisory TAC elected District/Regional Councils **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** law Governor adapts laws/makes regulations; President assents council laws on specified subjects; Governor assents **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M4. Compare the Fifth and Sixth Schedules as competing models of tribal governance. (15 marks, 250 words)".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "M4. Compare the Fifth and Sixth Schedules as competing models of tribal governance. (15...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

M5. PESA is a calibrated code of community power, not a universal Gram Sabha veto. Discuss. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model solution

Thesis: [FACT] PESA section 4 assigns different powers to the Gram Sabha and Panchayats according to the decision; [ANALYSIS] its strength lies in legal precision, not a single maximalist verb.

Approval: Gram Sabha approves village-level social/economic plans, programmes and projects before implementation and identifies beneficiaries.

Certification: Village Panchayat obtains Gram Sabha certification of fund utilisation.

Consultation: Gram Sabha or appropriate Panchayat is consulted before land acquisition and R&R in Scheduled Areas. [LIMIT] Consultation is not statutory universal consent.

Mandatory recommendation: Prior recommendation is required for specified prospecting licences/mining leases for minor minerals and for auction concessions, with the statutory holder varying by clause.

Substantive endowment: State law must endow ownership of minor forest produce, village-market control, regulation of money-lending/intoxicants, land-alienation prevention/restoration, local-plan/resource control and social-sector oversight.

Named evidence: [FACT] PESA's habitation-based village and cultural-resource safeguard recognise living customary institutions. [CURRENT] Official MoPR material lists nine State rule regimes; notification does not prove cross-sector compliance.

Critical gap: large Gram Panchayat boundaries, weak records, sectoral-law inconsistency and formal meetings can dilute powers.

Verdict: Courts and administrators should enforce the exact statutory verb at each project stage while States strengthen Gram Sabha information, inclusion and remedy.

Why this earns marks: It directly proves the proposition with section-specific verbs, then adds implementation and qualification.

How to improve / compress: Quote the exact PESA verb for each proposition; in a 150-word answer retain approve, consult, recommend and restore, and delete general participation rhetoric.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "M5. PESA is a calibrated code of community power, not a universal Gram Sabha veto. Discuss...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M5. PESA is a calibrated code of community power, not a universal Gram Sabha veto. Discuss. (15 marks, 250 words)".

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** M5. PESA is a calibrated code of community power, not a universal Gram Sabha veto. Discuss. (15 marks, 250 words) **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** Thesis: [FACT] PESA section 4 assigns different powers to the Gram Sabha and Panchayats according to the decision; [ANALYSIS] its strength lies in legal precision, not a single maximalist verb. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** Approval: Gram Sabha approves village-level social/economic plans, programmes and projects before implementation and identifies beneficiaries. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or

legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Certification: Village Panchayat obtains Gram Sabha certification of fund utilisation. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Consultation: Gram Sabha or appropriate Panchayat is consulted before land acquisition and R&R in Scheduled Areas. [LIMIT] Consultation is not statutory universal consent. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M5. PESA is a calibrated code of community power, not a universal Gram Sabha veto. Discuss. (15 marks, 250 words)".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "M5. PESA is a calibrated code of community power, not a universal Gram Sabha veto. Discuss....", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

M6. Analyse how the Fifth Schedule, PESA, FRA and judicial decisions regulate land and mining conflicts in tribal areas. (15 marks, 250 words)

Model solution

Thesis: [ANALYSIS] Tribal land/mining governance is cumulative: no one clearance or consultation substitutes for constitutional regulation, community power, forest-right recognition and sectoral law.

Fifth Schedule: Paragraph 5 permits regulations restricting tribal land transfer, allotment and money-lending. [ANALYSIS] It supplies the anti-alienation constitutional base, but the operative State regulation matters.

PESA: section 4 requires consultation for acquisition/R&R, mandatory prior recommendation for specified minor-mineral decisions and powers to prevent/restore alienated land. [LIMIT] Major minerals and all projects cannot be swept into one veto claim.

FRA: Gram Sabha initiates individual/community/CFR claims; section 5 adds conservation duties. [ANALYSIS] A project must first know whose rights and cultural relationships are affected.

Cases: [FACT] *Samatha (1997)* invalidated the impugned Andhra Pradesh Scheduled-Area mining leases under the State land-transfer regulation; its nationwide reach must be qualified. [FACT] *Orissa Mining Corporation (2013)* required Gram Sabha determination of FRA-linked cultural/religious claims, while MoEF retained the final Stage-II clearance decision.

Conflict mechanism: insecure records, debt, acquisition and forest diversion can combine to dispossess communities even where one procedure is formally completed.

Verdict: lawful development requires sequenced rights recognition, exact PESA compliance, environmental appraisal, reasoned alternatives and enforceable restoration/R&R.

Why this earns marks: It integrates four legal layers, uses two accurately bounded cases and explains the causal mechanism of dispossession.

How to improve / compress: Present the conflict as a sequence-territorial status, land-transfer law, PESA process, FRA recognition, environmental decision-and state the precise limit of each judgment.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on "M6. Analyse how the Fifth Schedule, PESA, FRA and judicial decisions regulate land and mining...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M6. Analyse how the Fifth Schedule, PESA, FRA and judicial decisions regulate land and mining conflicts in tribal areas. (15 marks, 250 words)".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** M6. Analyse how the Fifth Schedule, PESA, FRA and judicial decisions regulate land and mining conflicts in tribal areas. (15 marks, 250 words) **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Thesis: [ANALYSIS] Tribal land/mining governance is cumulative: no one clearance or consultation substitutes for constitutional regulation, community power, forest-right recognition and sectoral law. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Fifth Schedule: Paragraph 5 permits regulations restricting tribal land transfer, allotment and money-lending. [ANALYSIS] It supplies the anti-alienation constitutional base, but the operative State regulation matters. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** FRA: Gram Sabha initiates individual/community/CFR claims; section 5 adds conservation duties. [ANALYSIS] A project must first know whose rights and cultural relationships are affected. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Conflict mechanism: insecure records, debt, acquisition and forest diversion can combine to dispossess communities even where one procedure is formally completed. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M6. Analyse how the Fifth Schedule, PESA, FRA and judicial decisions regulate land and mining conflicts in tribal areas. (15 marks, 250 words)".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "M6. Analyse how the Fifth Schedule, PESA, FRA and judicial decisions regulate land and mining...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

M7. Design an accountability reform for Fifth and Sixth Schedule institutions. (20 marks, 250 words)

Model solution

Thesis: [ANALYSIS] Reform should preserve constitutional asymmetry while making every exercise or non-exercise of power visible, reasoned, participatory and remediable.

- 1. Territorial accuracy:** publish current Presidential Orders, habitation maps and council boundaries in accessible local formats; distinguish whole districts from partial coverage.
- 2. Governor accountability:** standardise annual Fifth Schedule reports around land alienation, PESA, FRA, services and outcomes; publish them with justified confidentiality exceptions. Require reasoned disposal of TAC advice.
- 3. TAC renewal:** fixed meeting calendar, community/expert evidence, public agendas and action-taken statements. [LIMIT] retain its advisory constitutional character.
- 4. PESA implementation:** harmonise Panchayat, excise, market, money-lending, land and minor-mineral laws; notify the remaining rules gap; support habitation-level Gram Sabhas and inclusive meetings.
- 5. Sixth Schedule capacity:** activity, staff and fund maps; assent timelines and reasons; independent audit; transparent council law databases; strengthen village/council-court training and appeal records.
- 6. Land/FRA infrastructure:** geo-referenced but privacy-sensitive land/CFR records, legal aid and restoration tracking.
- 7. Project sequencing:** rights determination -> statutory consultation/recommendation -> environmental/social appraisal -> reasoned decision -> monitored R&R/restoration.
- 8. Intergovernmental review:** use Articles 275/339 and State departments for capacity and convergence, not command substitution.

Qualification: digitisation can exclude remote communities; custom cannot override equality and dignity.

Verdict: accountability should align who decides, who implements, who records reasons and who can obtain a remedy.

Why this earns marks: It offers a sequenced institution-specific design, protects autonomy and attaches qualifications to each reform logic.

How to improve / compress: Prioritise six executable reforms with actor, action and accountability indicator; compress the diagnosis to one opening paragraph in a 250-word response.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "M7. Design an accountability reform for Fifth and Sixth Schedule institutions. (20 marks, 250...)"; all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M7. Design an accountability reform for Fifth and Sixth Schedule institutions. (20 marks, 250 words)".

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** M7. Design an accountability reform for Fifth and Sixth Schedule institutions. (20 marks, 250 words) **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Thesis: [ANALYSIS] Reform should preserve constitutional asymmetry while making every exercise or non-exercise of power visible, reasoned, participatory and remediable. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Territorial accuracy: publish current Presidential Orders, habitation maps and council boundaries in accessible local formats; distinguish whole districts from partial coverage. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** TAC renewal: fixed meeting calendar, community/expert evidence, public agendas and action-taken statements. [LIMIT] retain its advisory constitutional character. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** PESA implementation: harmonise Panchayat, excise, market, money-lending, land and minor-mineral laws; notify the remaining rules gap; support habitation-level Gram Sabhas and inclusive meetings. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M7. Design an accountability reform for Fifth and Sixth Schedule institutions. (20 marks, 250 words)".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "M7. Design an accountability reform for Fifth and Sixth Schedule institutions. (20 marks, 250...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

M8. Should Sixth Schedule-style autonomy be extended to Ladakh or other tribal regions? Critically examine. (20 marks, 250 words)

Model solution

Thesis: [ANALYSIS] Extension should follow institutional fit, not population alone: the issue is which legal form best protects land, culture, representation and accountable development within the relevant State/UT structure.

Case for extension: elected territorial councils can legislate on land/custom, manage services, raise specified revenue and provide continuous local voice. [CURRENT] Ladakh's official dialogue concerns land, culture, employment and empowerment of hill councils; no Sixth Schedule status has been enacted.

Why the model attracts demands: [FACT] Sixth Schedule councils are stronger than a Fifth Schedule TAC and ordinary administrative councils because they combine legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers.

Limits: the Schedule presently operates in four named States; council boundaries can create minority-insider disputes; gubernatorial assent, weak staff/funds and State overlap can reduce promised autonomy. Ladakh is a UT with existing hill councils and strategic/ecological constraints, so transplantation requires careful legal design.

Alternatives/complements: an Article 371-type provision, strengthened elected hill councils, land/employment legislation, cultural-language guarantees, legislative representation or a tailored parliamentary framework may better match some regions.

Decision test: territorial compactness; customary institutions; consent of affected groups; minority safeguards; fiscal viability; relation with State/UT legislature; judicial and audit accountability.

Qualification: [LIMIT] high ST population is evidence of need, not a self-executing constitutional entitlement to one model.

Verdict: consider Sixth Schedule extension where territorial self-government is the proportional solution, but choose through transparent consultation and enacted constitutional design rather than slogan or analogy.

Why this earns marks: It uses current Ladakh control, compares institutional benefits and costs, offers alternatives and answers "should" with a conditional test.

How to improve / compress: Keep the Ladakh status sentence dated and conditional; compare Sixth Schedule benefits with institutional fit, then mention two tailored alternatives before the verdict.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on "M8. Should Sixth Schedule-style autonomy be extended to Ladakh or other tribal regions?...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M8. Should Sixth Schedule-style autonomy be extended to Ladakh or other tribal regions? Critically examine. (20 marks, 250 words)".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** M8. Should Sixth Schedule-style autonomy be extended to Ladakh or other tribal regions? Critically examine. (20 marks, 250 words) **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Why the model attracts demands: [FACT] Sixth Schedule councils are stronger than a Fifth Schedule TAC and ordinary administrative councils because they combine legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Decision test: territorial compactness; customary institutions; consent of affected groups; minority safeguards; fiscal viability; relation with State/UT legislature; judicial and audit accountability. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Qualification: [LIMIT] high ST population is evidence of need, not a self-executing constitutional entitlement to one model. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Verdict: consider Sixth Schedule extension where territorial self-government is the proportional solution, but choose through transparent consultation and enacted constitutional design rather than slogan or analogy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "M8. Should Sixth Schedule-style autonomy be extended to Ladakh or other tribal regions? Critically examine. (20 marks, 250 words)".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

How to improve this answer: For "M8. Should Sixth Schedule-style autonomy be extended to Ladakh or other tribal regions?...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or

source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Scheduled & Tribal Areas (Article 244, Fifth & Sixth Schedules, Part X) - ADVANCED / COMPLETE

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 41 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF). **FACT:** = from source book · **ANALYSIS:** = inference / case law · **CURRENT:** = current affairs. *Companion:* basic/Scheduled-and-Tribal-Areas.md.

THE BIG PICTURE □

FACT: Art 244 (Part X) envisages a special administrative system for "**scheduled areas**" and "**tribal areas**":

Schedule	Covers	Applies to
FACT: Fifth Schedule	Administration & control of scheduled areas & STs	Any state EXCEPT Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram
FACT: Sixth Schedule	Administration of tribal areas	The 4 NE states: Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram

FACT: 10 states have Fifth Schedule Areas (2019): AP, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, HP, Jharkhand, MP, Maharashtra, Odisha, Rajasthan.

PART A - FIFTH SCHEDULE (Administration of Scheduled Areas) □

FACT: Rationale: inhabited by **aboriginals**, socially/economically backward -> the normal state machinery is not fully extended and the **Centre has greater responsibility**.

1. **FACT: Declaration:** the **President** declares/alters/rescinds a scheduled area (in consultation with the Governor).
2. **FACT: Executive power:** state's executive power extends there, ****but the Governor has a special responsibility - must send an annual report to the President; the Centre can give directions**** on administration.
3. **FACT: Tribes Advisory Council (TAC):** every Fifth-Schedule state must set one up - ****20 members, 3/4 being ST MLAs**** of the state assembly.
4. **FACT: Governor's powers:** may direct that an Act of Parliament/state legislature does **not apply** (or applies with modifications) to a scheduled area; may make **regulations** (prohibit/restrict land transfer among tribals, regulate money-lending) - all such regulations need the **President's assent**.
 - **FACT: Article 339(1) commissions:** the President was required to appoint one after ten years from commencement and may appoint further commissions; **Dhebar (1960)** and **Bhuria (2002)** are the standard examples.

PART B - SIXTH SCHEDULE (Administration of Tribal Areas) □

FACT: For the 4 NE states (Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram) whose tribes retain their own culture -> given **autonomy** for self-government.

Feature	Detail
FACT: Autonomous Districts	Tribal areas constituted as autonomous districts (still within state executive authority); Governor organises/reorganises them
FACT: Autonomous Regions	Where different tribes exist within a district
FACT: District Council	Ordinary model: up to 30 members - 4 Governor-nominated + 26 elected, 5-year elected term; Bodoland Territorial Council is a special 46-member exception
FACT: Law-making	Councils legislate on land, forests, canal water, shifting cultivation, inheritance, marriage/divorce, social customs - need Governor's assent
FACT: Judicial	Councils can constitute village councils/courts for tribal disputes
FACT: Finance	Assess & collect land revenue + specified taxes; manage schools, markets, ferries, roads
FACT: Application of Acts varies	State-specific Sixth-Schedule paragraphs govern non-application or application with exceptions/modifications; do not use one blanket rule

FACT: **Special Article 244A**: allows formation of an **autonomous state** within Assam (with its own legislature/CoM).

PART C - FIFTH vs SIXTH SCHEDULE (compare) □□

Point	Fifth Schedule	Sixth Schedule
FACT: Applies to	Scheduled areas in 10 states (except the 4 NE)	Tribal areas in 4 NE states
FACT: Key body	Tribes Advisory Council (advisory)	Autonomous District/Regional Councils (law-making + executive)
FACT: Degree of autonomy	Lower (protective; Governor/Centre-driven)	Higher (genuine self-government with elected councils)
FACT: Declares/controls	President declares; Governor reports	Governor organises districts; councils legislate

UPSC Traps

- WRONG: Sixth Schedule applies to all NE states -> only **Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram** (not Nagaland/Manipur/ Arunachal).
- WRONG: Fifth Schedule covers the whole country -> **excludes the 4 Sixth-Schedule states**.
- WRONG: Tribes Advisory Council makes laws -> it is **advisory** only; the **District Councils** (Sixth Schedule) legislate.
- WRONG: District Council has 30 all-elected members -> **26 elected + 4 nominated** by the Governor.
- WRONG: President declares tribal areas under the Sixth Schedule -> the **Governor** organises autonomous districts;

the **President** declares **scheduled areas** (Fifth Schedule).

- WRONG: Fifth-Schedule regulations need the Governor's assent -> they need the **President's** assent.

CURRENT: CA hooks

- CURRENT: ANALYSIS: **Ladakh's demand for Sixth Schedule status** (tribal-majority UT) - a major live agitation (links to Ch 22 & Ch 25).
- CURRENT: ANALYSIS: **PESA (1996)** extends Panchayat provisions to **Fifth Schedule** areas - Gram Sabha empowerment (links to Ch 23).

- CURRENT: ANALYSIS: **Forest Rights Act 2006** & tribal land alienation, mining consent, Governor's under-used special powers.
- CURRENT: ANALYSIS: Demands for **new autonomous councils** (e.g., in Assam) & Bodoland accord implementation.

Mains angles

- Compare the Fifth and Sixth Schedules as models of tribal self-governance - which better protects tribal identity?
- "The Governor's special responsibility under the Fifth Schedule remains largely dormant." Examine.
- Should the Sixth Schedule be extended to Ladakh and other tribal regions? Discuss.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Article 244 and territorial vocabulary

Rapid recall	Rule
Article 244(1)	Fifth Schedule: Scheduled Areas/ST administration outside the four Sixth Schedule States
Article 244(2)	Sixth Schedule: tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram
Scheduled Area	President declares/changes through the Fifth Schedule order route
tribal area	Sixth Schedule constitutional territorial category
Scheduled Tribe	Article 342 President notification; Parliament changes by law
Article 244A	Parliament may create an autonomous State within Assam

AREA STATUS != TRIBE STATUS != COUNCIL ORGANISATION
 President President/Parliament Governor
 Fifth Schedule Article 342 Sixth Schedule

Constitutional rationale and history

- Colonial excluded/partially excluded administration concentrated executive control.
- A.V. Thakkar and Gopinath Bordoloi subcommittees informed the two-model constitutional settlement.
- Fifth Schedule = protective supervision.
- Sixth Schedule = territorial self-government.
- PESA = Fifth Schedule self-government layer.
- FRA = forest-right recognition and community-resource governance.
- Best thesis: differentiated administration is legitimate as substantive equality only when it produces agency and accountability.

Fifth Schedule State and declaration control

10 STATES
 AP | Telangana | Chhattisgarh | Gujarat | Himachal Pradesh
 Jharkhand | Madhya Pradesh | Maharashtra | Odisha | Rajasthan

- Only notified territory is scheduled; not the whole State.
- Official criteria: tribal preponderance; compactness/reasonable size; viable unit; comparative economic backwardness.
- Criteria guide; Presidential Order creates status.
- Consultation with Governor is not consent.

Fifth Schedule institutional chain

State administration continues

- > Governor report annually / when required
- > President
- > Union directions on administration

- No automatic local-body or Union takeover.
- TAC: maximum 20; ST Assembly-representation rule; advice on matters referred by Governor.
- TAC is advisory, not legislative.
- Governor may non-apply/adapt parliamentary or State laws, including retrospectively.
- Governor regulations: peace/good government; land transfer; land allotment; money-lending.
- Consult TAC where it exists.
- Regulation has no effect until President assents.
- Do not claim unqualified personal gubernatorial discretion.

Article 275 and Article 339

Provision	Recall
275(1)	grants for ST welfare schemes and raising Scheduled-Area administration
339(1)	presidential commission on Scheduled Areas/ST welfare
339(2)	Union directions on essential State ST-welfare schemes

- Dhebar and Bhuria are the two standard commission names.
- A grant supports capacity; it does not prove outcomes or devolution.

Sixth Schedule architecture

STATE

- > autonomous district
 - > different ST areas may become autonomous regions
 - > District Council / Regional Council
- Four States only: Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram.
- Autonomous district remains inside State executive authority.
- Ordinary council: up to 30; up to four nominated; rest elected; elected term ordinarily five years.
- BTC special design: 46 = 40 elected + 6 nominated.
- Assam examples: BTC, Karbi Anglong, Dima Hasao/North Cachar Hills.
- Meghalaya: Khasi, Jaintia, Garo.
- Tripura: TTAADC.
- Mizoram: Chakma, Lai, Mara.

Sixth Schedule powers and limits

Power	Core	Limit
legislative	land, non-reserved forest, water, shifting cultivation, village administration, chiefs, inheritance, marriage/divorce, social customs	specified subjects; Governor assent
executive	schools, dispensaries, markets, ferries, fisheries, roads and entrusted functions	transfer/staff/funds vary
judicial	village/council courts for specified tribal-party matters	not complete replacement of ordinary courts
fiscal	land revenue and specified local taxes; funds	audit and legal limits
minerals	royalty share mechanism	not mineral ownership

- Paragraphs 3A/3B = special Assam additional subjects.
- Article 244A = autonomous-State enabling route, not current ADC status.
- State-specific paragraphs govern application of laws; never use one universal formula.
- Governor has specified assent, inquiry, suspension and dissolution/supersession controls.
- President is not routine assent authority for council laws.

Fifth-Sixth exact comparison

Fifth	Sixth
Scheduled Areas in 10 States	tribal areas in four States
President declares territory	Governor organises districts/regions within constitutional list
TAC advice	elected council government
Governor law adaptation/regulations	council legislation
President assents regulations	Governor assents council laws
State administration + Union directions	council functions within State authority
no TAC courts/taxes	specified courts/taxes
PESA applies	PESA does not apply

Memory: Fifth gives a constitutional guardian plus PESA; Sixth gives a bounded territorial government.

PESA power code

APPROVE local plans/programmes/projects
 IDENTIFY beneficiaries
 CERTIFY fund utilisation
 CONSULT acquisition and R&R
 RECOMMEND minor-mineral licences/leases/concessions
 MANAGE minor water bodies at appropriate Panchayat level
 OWN minor forest produce through State-law endowment
 PREVENT + RESTORE land alienation
 REGULATE money-lending, markets, intoxicants
 CONTROL social-sector institutions, local plans/resources

- PESA applies to Fifth Schedule areas only.
- Village can be habitation/hamlet based.
- State law must respect custom and community-resource management.
- Acquisition-linked project planning/implementation remains coordinated at State level.
- State law should endeavour to follow the Sixth Schedule pattern in district-level administrative arrangements.
- ST seats at least half; all chairperson posts reserved for STs.
- Consultation != recommendation != approval != universal veto.
- Official control on 19 Aug 2026: nine State rule regimes listed; Odisha not separately listed; Jharkhand Rules 2025 listed.

FRA linkage

- Gram Sabha initiates and verifies claims; SDLC and DLC complete the statutory chain.
- IFR != community rights != Community Forest Resource rights.
- CFR: protect, regenerate, conserve or manage customary community forest resource.
- Section 5 links rights with conservation duties.
- FRA does not transfer all forest or mineral ownership.
- PESA asks who participates with what local power; FRA asks who holds which forest right.

Land, mining and case law

Fifth Schedule regulation

- + PESA decision-stage power
- + FRA rights determination
- + State land/mineral law
- + acquisition/R&R
- + forest/environment clearance
- = lawful cumulative decision

- *Samatha (1997)*: Andhra Pradesh Scheduled-Area land-transfer regulation invalidated impugned private mining leases; always state the State-law boundary and later scope qualification.
- *Orissa Mining Corporation (2013)*: Gram Sabha decided FRA-linked community/cultural/religious claims; MoEF made final Stage-II decision in light of those decisions.
- Never write "Niyamgiri = universal Gram Sabha veto".
- Royalty sharing != consent; compensation != recognition of sacred/community rights.

Article 371 and ordinary Panchayat distinction

Model	Do not confuse with
Article 371A/371G and other 371 provisions	automatic Sixth Schedule council
ordinary Part IX Panchayat	PESA habitation Gram Sabha or ADC
PESA	Sixth Schedule
hill council created by statute	constitutional ADC unless Sixth Schedule applies

- Article 243M excludes Scheduled/tribal areas from automatic Part IX application.
- PESA extends modified Part IX to Fifth Schedule areas.
- Custom remains subject to constitutional rights and valid law.

Accountability and reform recall

1. Publish current area/council boundaries.
2. Standardise and publish Governor reports.
3. Give TAC fixed calendars, evidence and action-taken responses.
4. Harmonise PESA with sectoral land, market, excise, money-lending and mineral laws.
5. Map council functions, staff and funds.
6. Set transparent assent timelines and reasons.
7. Build accessible land/CFR records and restoration remedies.
8. Sequence rights, participation, appraisal, decision and R&R.
9. Use ITDAs/convergence as administrative support, never substitutes for constitutional bodies.
10. Protect women, PVTGs and internal minorities within local autonomy.

Last-minute PYQ routes and traps

Year/Q	Demand	Control
2019 Q50	schedule protecting tribal land from mining transfer	exact paper verified; local key unavailable
2022 Q73	Fifth Schedule consequences	neutral demand only; no reconstructed wording/key
2023 Q39	notification and administrative hierarchy	exact paper verified; key unavailable
2024 Q84	who declares ST and State-specific status	official key B
2025 Q56	State executive power/Union takeover trap	official key D
2026 Q57	schedules, tax exemption and Panchayat reservation	exact paper; provisional key not recorded/inferred

1. Fifth = 244(1); Sixth = 244(2).
2. President declares Scheduled Area.
3. Governor does not declare ST list.
4. State executive power continues.
5. TAC advises.
6. Fifth regulation -> President assent.
7. Sixth council law -> Governor assent.
8. ADC ordinary ceiling is not universal composition.
9. Reserved forests excluded from ordinary paragraph 3 forest field.
10. PESA applies to Fifth, not Sixth.
11. Consultation is not universal consent.
12. Niyamgiri kept final Stage-II decision with MoEF.

Rapid Mains spines

Fifth Schedule

Article 244(1) -> Presidential territory -> State power + Governor report + Union directions -> TAC -> law adaptation/regulations -> PESA/FRA -> dormancy/accountability -> qualified protective-governance verdict.

Sixth Schedule

Article 244(2) -> district/region -> composition and Assam exceptions -> legislative/executive/judicial/fiscal powers -> Governor/State/Parliament limits -> capacity and internal representation -> bounded-self-government verdict.

PESA

Article 243M exclusion -> habitation village -> exact verbs -> sectoral-law implementation -> FRA linkage -> records/capacity/remedy -> calibrated-community-power verdict.

Land/mining

land status and State regulation -> PESA stage -> FRA rights -> environment/mineral/acquisition law -> *Samatha (1997)*/OMC with limits -> cumulative-compliance verdict.

Final twenty-second recall

FIFTH:

President area | Governor report/regulate | TAC advise | President assent | PESA

SIXTH:

AMTM | district/region | council laws/services/courts/taxes | Governor assent

RIGHTS:

PESA verbs + FRA claims/CFR + State land law + bounded cases

VERDICT:

protection must become accountable community agency

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Article 244 starting point and the autonomy-development rationale

ROOT PROBLEM

ordinary territorial administration may reproduce dispossession and weak bargaining power.

ARTICLE 244(1)

Fifth Schedule -> Scheduled Areas and Scheduled Tribes outside the Sixth Schedule map.

ARTICLE 244(2)

Sixth Schedule -> tribal areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram.

ARTICLE 244A

Parliament may create an autonomous State within Assam with legislature/CoM.

TERMS

Scheduled Tribe = Article 342 community status
| Scheduled Area = presidential territorial declaration
| tribal area = Sixth Schedule territorial unit.

CORE IDEA differentiated institutions pursue substantive equality within one Constitution.

MUST REMEMBER: Keep Article 244, Article 244A, the Fifth Schedule and the Sixth Schedule separate before adding the statutory PESA and FRA layers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Fifth Schedule: declaration, Governor, TAC and regulation chain

SCHEDULED AREA

President declares, enlarges, diminishes or alters after the constitutional consultation route.

EXECUTIVE CHAIN

State executive applies -> Governor reports annually/when required to President
-> Union may issue directions on administration.

TRIBES ADVISORY COUNCIL

up to 20 members; as nearly as may be three-fourths ST legislators in the State.
advises on ST welfare/advancement matters referred by Governor.

GOVERNOR'S REGULATION

peace and good government -> restrict/prohibit tribal land transfer
-> regulate allotment -> regulate money-lending
-> may amend State/Parliament law for the area.

CHECK

regulation requires Presidential assent; personal-discretion claims need exact authority.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Sixth Schedule territory, council composition and four-State scope

SCOPE

Assam | Meghalaya | Tripura | Mizoram only.

AUTONOMOUS DISTRICT

Governor organises territory; multiple tribes may form autonomous regions.

ORDINARY DISTRICT COUNCIL MODEL

not more than 30 members -> up to four nominated by Governor

-> remainder elected by adult suffrage -> normally five-year elected term.

REGIONAL COUNCIL

created for an autonomous region; powers follow the Schedule and applicable rules.

ASSAM VARIATION

special paragraphs/statutes/accord implementation may modify composition and powers.

LIMIT ADC != State, municipality, ordinary Panchayat or Article 244A autonomous State.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Sixth Schedule legislative, executive, judicial and fiscal powers

LEGISLATIVE

land other than reserved forest | non-reserved forest | shifting cultivation

| village administration | inheritance | marriage/divorce | social customs.

Governor assent is required for council laws.

EXECUTIVE

primary schools, dispensaries, markets, roads and specified local services.

JUDICIAL

village courts/council courts for specified tribal-party disputes

subject to constitutional/statutory supervision and jurisdiction rules.

FISCAL

District/Regional Funds | land revenue | listed taxes/fees | mineral-royalty share.

CHECKS

Governor territorial and suspension/dissolution powers

| Parliament/State-law application controls | audit and judicial review.

LIMIT autonomy is substantial but enumerated and supervised, not sovereignty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Fifth and Sixth Schedules: complete close-option comparison

DIMENSION

	FIFTH SCHEDULE	SIXTH SCHEDULE
States	multiple notified States	Assam/Meghalaya/Tripura/Mizoram
territory	Scheduled Area	autonomous district/region
core body	Governor + TAC	elected District/Regional Council
law mechanism	Governor regulation	council law + Governor assent
judicial power	no Schedule-created ADC courts	council/village courts in listed field
finance	State/Union channels	own funds + listed taxes/royalty share
local democracy	PESA in covered areas	council system; Part IX ordinarily
excluded		

COMMON PURPOSE

land/custom protection + self-government + development administration.

TRAP

TAC is advisory, not an ADC | Sixth Schedule does not cover every North-Eastern State.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: PESA, FRA, land and resource rights with judicial boundaries

PESA, 1996

Part IX extension to Fifth Schedule areas -> customary village/Gram Sabha
-> plans/resources/markets/land safeguards through exact statutory verbs.

FRA, 2006

individual/community forest rights + community forest-resource governance
through its own claim and recognition procedure.

LAND / MINING CHAIN

territorial law -> land-transfer rule -> PESA role -> FRA rights
-> forest/environment clearance -> rehabilitation -> judicial review.

Samatha (1997)

protected Scheduled-Area land under the applicable Andhra Pradesh regime;
not a detached nationwide mining ban.

Orissa Mining Corporation (2013)

Gram Sabhas determined specified FRA religious/community-right claims at Niyamgiri;
not an unlimited veto over every project.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: PESA section 4 uses distinct verbs: approval, consultation, mandatory prior
recommendation, ownership and control. None creates one universal veto.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Scheduled Tribe safeguards beyond territorial autonomy

RIGHTS AND REPRESENTATION

Article 46 -> education/economic interests and protection from exploitation.

Articles 330/332 -> ST political reservation in Lok Sabha/State Assemblies.

Article 335 -> service claims consistent with administrative efficiency.

FINANCE AND OVERSIGHT

Article 275(1) -> specified grants

| Article 338A -> National Commission for Scheduled Tribes

| Article 339 -> commission and Union welfare-scheme directions.

NCST ROLE

monitor safeguards -> inquire into complaints -> advise planning

-> report to President -> recommendations and follow-up.

BOUNDARY

NCST does not replace Governor/TAC, Gram Sabha, ADC, courts or elected governments.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Article 371, Panchayats and autonomous-council boundaries

DO NOT COLLAPSE FOUR SYSTEMS

Article 371A/371G -> State-specific Part XXI consent shields.

Fifth Schedule -> Governor/TAC administration for Scheduled Areas.

Sixth Schedule -> autonomous district/regional councils in four States.

ordinary Part IX -> Panchayats outside exclusions; PESA modifies Fifth Schedule route.

ACCOUNTABILITY TENSIONS

autonomy vs elite capture | custom vs individual rights

| development vs land/resource security | Governor oversight vs elected legitimacy.

CURRENT CONTROL

Ladakh or other demands for Sixth Schedule/Statehood/Article 371 safeguards

remain proposals until the Constitution or law is validly changed.

REFORM

clear jurisdiction + audited funds + accessible laws + women/community voice

-> transparent Governor action + timely rights recognition.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Prelims firewalls and Mains synthesis

PRELIMS FIREWALL

President declares Scheduled Areas | Governor makes Fifth Schedule regulations
| President assents | TAC advisory | ADC laws need Governor assent
| reserved forest excluded from listed ADC forest power
| Article 244A applies only within Assam.

PYQ ROUTES

Fifth/Sixth identification | council composition/powers
| PESA verbs | FRA relationship | Article 275/339 | land/mining case limits.

MAINS SPINE

define differentiated autonomy -> identify territory -> map institution/power
-> rights/development purpose -> accountability risk -> named case with limit
-> reform through voice, legality, capacity and audit.

SYNTHESIS

autonomy earns legitimacy when it protects land and custom while remaining inclusive,
reviewable, fiscally accountable and capable of delivering development.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Article 275(1), Article 339 and the Union accountability chain

ARTICLE 275(1)

grants-in-aid support Scheduled-Area administration and ST welfare schemes.

ARTICLE 339(1)

President appoints a commission on Scheduled Areas and ST welfare.

ARTICLE 339(2)

Union may direct States on schemes essential to ST welfare.

ACCOUNTABILITY ROUTE

local evidence -> Governor report -> Union scrutiny -> funded corrective action.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: PESA exact-verb decision ladder and FRA interface

PESA SECTION 4

Gram Sabha approves plans; identifies beneficiaries; certifies fund use; is consulted
before land acquisition; gives mandatory recommendation for specified minor-mineral
decisions; owns minor forest produce; controls markets and money-lending; prevents and
restores alienated land.

FRA, 2006

Gram Sabha initiates rights claims and protects community forest resources.

LIMIT

consultation, recommendation and approval are not interchangeable and do not create one
universal veto.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Current controls, reform route and extension test

DATED CONTROL – 28 AUGUST 2026

Fifth Schedule areas remain notified in 10 States. Jharkhand PESA Rules, 2025 are listed by MoPR; no separate Odisha rules instrument is listed. Ladakh remains outside the Sixth Schedule.

REFORM ROUTE

publish outcome-based Governor reports -> reasoned TAC disposal -> align State laws with PESA -> strengthen ADC audit and own-source revenue -> converge FRA records and legal aid.

EXTENSION TEST

tribal geography + customary institutions + democratic demand + viable powers + federal fit; never treat Sixth Schedule as an automatic template.

LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: The 4 August 2026 MHA parliamentary answer identifies ten Sixth-Schedule ADCs in four States; Ladakh remains outside the Sixth Schedule.